

Neurosurgeon: Collaborative Intelligence Between the Cloud and Mobile Edge

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Abstract

The computation for today's intelligent personal assistants such as Apple Siri, Google Now, and Microsoft Cortana, is performed in the cloud. This cloud-only approach requires significant amounts of data to be sent to the cloud over the wireless network and puts significant computational pressure on the datacenter. However, as the computational resources in mobile devices become more powerful and energy efficient, questions arise as to whether this cloud-only processing is desirable moving forward, and what are the implications of pushing some or all of this compute to the mobile devices on the edge.

In this paper, we examine the status quo approach of cloud-only processing and investigate computation partitioning strategies that effectively leverage both the cycles in the cloud and on the mobile device to achieve low latency, low energy consumption, and high datacenter throughput for this class of intelligent applications. Our study uses 8 intelligent applications spanning computer vision, speech, and natural language domains, all employing state-of-the-art Deep Neural Networks (DNNs) as the core machine learning technique. We find that given the characteristics of DNN algorithms, a fine-grained, layer-level computation partitioning strategy based on the data and computation variations of each layer within a DNN has significant latency and energy advantages over the status quo approach.

Using this insight, we design *Neurosurgeon*, a lightweight scheduler to automatically partition DNN computation between mobile devices and datacenters at the granularity of neural network layers. *Neurosurgeon* does not require per-application profiling. It adapts to various DNN architectures, hardware platforms, wireless networks, and server load levels, intelligently partitioning computation for

best latency or best mobile energy. We evaluate *Neurosurgeon* on a state-of-the-art mobile development platform and show that it improves end-to-end latency by $3.1\times$ on average and up to $40.7\times$, reduces mobile energy consumption by 59.5% on average and up to 94.7%, and improves datacenter throughput by $1.5\times$ on average and up to $6.7\times$.

Keywords mobile computing; cloud computing; deep neural networks; intelligent applications

1. Introduction

The way we interact with today's mobile devices is rapidly changing as these devices are increasingly personal and knowledgeable. Intelligent Personal Assistants (IPAs), such as Apple Siri, Google Now, and Microsoft Cortana, are integrated by default on mobile devices and are expected to grow in popularity as wearables and smart home devices continue to gain traction [1, 2]. The primary interface with these intelligent mobile applications is using speech or images to navigate the device and ask questions. Demand for this mode of interaction is expected to replace the traditional text based inputs [3–5].

Processing speech and image inputs for IPA applications requires accurate and highly sophisticated machine learning techniques, the most common of which are Deep Neural Networks (DNNs). DNNs have become increasingly popular as the core machine learning technique in these applications due to their ability to achieve high accuracy for tasks such as speech recognition, image classification and natural language understanding. Many companies, including Google, Microsoft, Facebook, and Baidu, are using DNNs as the machine learning component for numerous applications in their production systems [6–8].

Prior work has shown that speech or image queries for DNN-based intelligent applications require orders of magnitude more processing than text based inputs [9]. The common wisdom has been that traditional mobile devices cannot support this large amount of computation with reasonable latency and energy consumption. Thus, the status quo approach used by web service providers for intelligent applications has been to host all the computation on high-end cloud servers [10–13]. Queries generated from a user's mo-

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神经外科医生：云和移动边缘之间的协作智能

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抽象的

当今的智能个人助理（例如 Apple Siri、Google Now 和 Microsoft Cortana）的计算是在云端执行的。这种仅基于云的方法需要通过无线网络将大量数据发送到云，并给数据中心带来巨大的计算压力。然而，随着移动设备中的计算资源变得更加强大和节能，人们提出了这样的问题：这种纯云处理是否值得继续发展，以及将部分或全部计算推到边缘移动设备会产生什么影响。

在本文中，我们研究了仅云处理的现状方法，并研究了有效利用云中和移动设备上的周期的计算分区策略，以实现此类智能应用程序的低延迟、低能耗和高数据中心吞吐量。我们的研究使用了 8 个跨越计算机视觉、语音和自然语言领域的智能应用程序，所有应用程序都采用最先进的深度神经网络 (DNN) 作为核心机器学习技术。我们发现，考虑到 DNN 算法的特点，基于 DNN 中每一层的数据和计算变化的细粒度、层级计算划分策略比现有方法具有显著的延迟和能量优势。

利用这一见解，我们设计了 *Neurosurgeon*，这是一个轻量级调度程序，可以按照神经网络层的粒度自动在移动设备和数据中心之间划分 DNN 计算。

Neurosurgeon 不需要每个应用程序分析。它适应各种 DNN 架构、硬件平台、无线网络和服务器负载水平，智能划分计算

最佳延迟或最佳移动能源。我们在最先进的移动开发平台上对 *Neurosurgeon* 进行了评估，结果表明，它使端到端延迟平均提高了 $3.1\times$ ，最高可达 $40.7\times$ ，移动能耗平均降低了 59.5% ，最高可达 94.7% ，数据中心吞吐量平均提高了 $1.5\times$ ，最高可达 $6.7\times$ 。

Keywords 移动计算；云计算；深度神经网络；智能应用

一、简介

随着当今移动设备变得越来越个性化和知识化，我们与这些设备的交互方式正在迅速变化。智能个人助理 (IPA)，例如 Apple Siri、Google Now 和 Microsoft Cortana，默认集成在移动设备上，并且随着可穿戴设备和智能家居设备的不断发展，预计将越来越受欢迎 [1, 2]。这些智能移动应用程序的主要界面是使用语音或图像来导航设备并提出问题。对这种交互模式的需求预计将取代传统的基于文本的输入 [3-5]。

处理 IPA 应用的语音和图像输入需要准确且高度复杂的机器学习技术，其中最常见的是深度神经网络 (DNN)。DNN 作为这些应用中的核心机器学习技术越来越受欢迎，因为它们能够实现语音识别、图像分类和自然语言理解等任务的高精度。许多公司，包括谷歌、微软、Facebook 和百度，都在其生产系统中使用 DNN 作为众多应用程序的机器学习组件 [6-8]。

先前的工作表明，基于 DNN 的智能应用程序的语音或图像查询需要比基于文本的输入多几个数量级的处理 [9]。人们普遍认为，传统移动设备无法以合理的延迟和能耗支持如此大量的计算。因此，网络服务提供商用于智能应用程序的现状方法是将所有计算托管在高端云服务器上 [10-13]。从用户的移动中生成的查询

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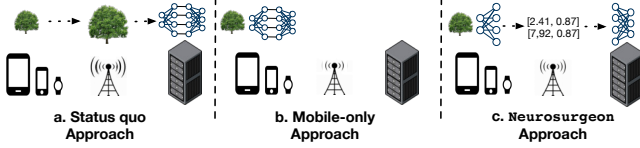


Figure 1: Status quo, mobile-only and the Neurosurgeon approach. Status quo approach performs all computation remotely in the cloud, the mobile-only approach performs all computation locally on the mobile device, and the Neurosurgeon approach partitions computation between the cloud and mobile device.

mobile device are sent to the cloud for processing, as shown in Figure 1a. However, with this approach, large amounts of data (e.g., images, video and audio) are uploaded to the server via the wireless network, resulting in high latency and energy costs.

While data transfer becomes the latency and energy bottleneck, performance and energy efficiency of modern mobile hardware have continued to improve through powerful mobile SoC integration [14, 15]. Motivated by this observation, this work re-examines the computation breakdown for intelligent applications between mobile and cloud. In particular, we investigate how computation can be pushed out of the cloud and onto the mobile devices on the edge to execute all or parts of these conventionally cloud-only applications. Key questions we address in this work include:

1. How feasible it is to execute large-scale intelligent workloads on today’s mobile platforms?
2. At what point is the cost of transferring speech and image data over the wireless network too high to justify cloud processing?
3. What role should the mobile edge play in providing processing support for intelligent applications requiring heavy computation?

Based on our investigation using 8 DNN-based intelligent applications spanning the domains of vision, speech, and natural language, we discover that, for some applications, due to the high data transfer overhead, locally executing on the mobile device (Figure 1b) can be up to $11\times$ faster than the cloud-only approach (Figure 1a). Furthermore, we find that instead of limiting the computation to be either executed entirely in the cloud or entirely on the mobile, a fine-grained layer-level partitioning strategy based on a DNN’s topology and constituent layers can achieve far superior end-to-end latency performance and mobile energy efficiency. By pushing compute out of the cloud and onto the mobile devices, we also improve datacenter throughput, allowing a given datacenter to support many more user queries, and creating a win-win situation for both the mobile and cloud systems.

Given the observation that ideal fine-grained DNN partition points depend on the layer compositions of the DNN, the particular mobile platform used, the wireless network configuration and the server load, we design a lightweight dynamic scheduler, Neurosurgeon. Neurosurgeon is a runtime system spanning cloud and mobile platforms that

automatically identifies the ideal partition points in DNNs and orchestrates the distribution of computation between the mobile device and the datacenter. As Figure 1c shows, Neurosurgeon partitions the DNN computation and takes advantage of the processing power of both the mobile and the cloud while reducing data transfer overhead. The detailed contributions of this paper are as follows:

- **In-depth examination of the status quo** – We show the latency and energy consumption of executing state-of-the-art DNNs in the cloud and on the mobile device. We observe that uploading via the wireless network is the bottleneck of the status quo approach, and mobile execution often provides better latency and energy consumption than the status quo approach. (Section 3)
- **DNN compute and data size characteristics study** – We provide an in-depth layer-level characterization of the compute and data size of 8 DNNs spanning across computer vision, speech and natural language processing. Our investigation reveals that DNN layers have significantly different compute and data size characteristics depending on their type and configurations. (Section 4)
- **DNN computation partitioning across the cloud and mobile edge** – Based on the compute and data characterization of DNN layers, we show that partitioning DNN at layer granularity offers significant performance benefits. We then design a systematic approach to identify the optimal points to partition computation for reduced latency and mobile energy consumption across a suite of applications. (Section 4)
- **Neurosurgeon runtime system and layer performance prediction models** – We develop a set of models to predict the latency and power consumption of a DNN layer based on its type and configuration, and create Neurosurgeon, a system to intelligently partition DNN computation between the mobile and cloud. We demonstrate that Neurosurgeon significantly improves end-to-end latency, reduces mobile energy consumption, and improves datacenter throughput. (Sections 5 and 6)

Our evaluation on a suite of 8 DNN applications shows that using Neurosurgeon on average improves end-to-end latency by $3.1\times$, reduces mobile energy consumption by 59.5%, and improves datacenter throughput by $1.5\times$.

2. Background

In this section, we provide an overview of Deep Neural Network (DNN) and describe how computer vision, speech, and natural language processing applications leverage DNNs as their core machine learning algorithm.

DNNs are organized in a directed graph where each node is a processing element (a neuron) that applies a function to its input and generates an output. Figure 2 depicts a 5 layer

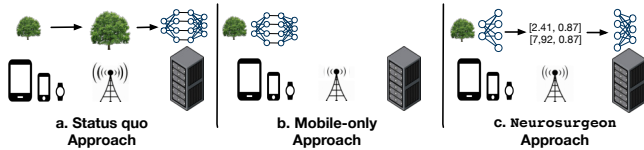


图 1：现状、仅限移动设备和 Neurosurgeon 方法。现状方法在云中远程执行所有计算，仅限移动方法在移动设备上本地执行所有计算，而 Neurosurgeon 方法在云和移动设备之间划分计算。

胆设备发送到云端进行处理，如图 1a 所示。然而，这种方法需要通过无线网络将大量数据（例如图像、视频和音频）上传到服务器，从而导致较高的延迟和能源成本。

虽然数据传输成为延迟和能源瓶颈，但现代移动硬件的性能和能源效率通过强大的移动 SoC 集成不断提高[14, 15]。受这一观察的启发，这项工作重新审视了移动和云之间智能应用程序的计算分解。特别是，我们研究了如何将计算从云中推出并转移到边缘的移动设备上，以执行这些传统上仅限云的应用程序的全部或部分。我们在这项工作中解决的关键问题包括：

1. 在当今的移动平台上执行大规模智能工作负载的可行性如何？
2. 在什么情况下，通过无线网络传输语音和图像数据的成本过高，以至于无法证明云处理的合理性？
3. 移动边缘在为需要大量计算的智能应用提供处理支持方面应发挥什么作用？

根据我们对涵盖视觉、语音和自然语言领域的 8 个基于 DNN 的智能应用程序的调查，我们发现，对于某些应用程序，由于数据传输开销较高，在移动设备上本地执行（图 1b）可以比仅云方法（图 1a）快 11 $\times$ 。此外，我们发现，基于 DNN 拓扑和组成层的细粒度层级划分策略可以实现远远优越的端到端延迟性能和移动能源效率，而不是限制计算完全在云端或完全在移动设备上执行。通过将计算从云端推到移动设备上，我们还提高了数据中心吞吐量，允许给定的数据中心支持更多的用户查询，并为移动和云系统创造双赢的局面。

鉴于理想的细粒度 DNN 划分点取决于 DNN 的层组成、使用的特定移动平台、无线网络配置和服务器负载，我们设计了一个轻量级动态调度程序 Neurosurgeon。Neurosurgeon 是一个跨越云和移动平台的运行时系统

自动识别 DNN 中的理想划分点并协调移动设备和数据中心之间的计算分布。如图 1c 所示，Neurosurgeon 对 DNN 计算进行分区，并利用移动设备和云的处理能力，同时减少数据传输开销。本文的详细贡献如下：

- 深入研究现状——我们展示了在云端和移动设备上执行最先进的 DNN 的延迟和能耗。我们观察到，通过无线网络上传是现状方法的瓶颈，而移动执行通常比现状方法提供更好的延迟和能耗。（第 3 节）
- DNN 计算和数据大小特征研究——我们提供了跨计算机视觉、语音和自然语言处理的 8 个 DNN 的计算和数据大小的深入分层特征。我们的调查表明，DNN 层根据其类型和配置具有显著不同的计算和数据大小特征。（第 4 节）
- 跨云和移动边缘的 DNN 计算分区——基于 DNN 层的计算和数据特征，我们表明在层粒度上分区 DNN 可提供显著的性能优势。然后，我们设计了一种系统方法来确定分区计算的最佳点，以减少一系列应用程序的延迟和移动能耗。（第 4 节）
- Neurosurgeon 运行时系统和层性能预测模型——我们开发了一组模型来根据 DNN 层的类型和配置来预测 DNN 层的延迟和功耗，并创建 Neurosurgeon，一个在移动设备和云端之间智能划分 DNN 计算的系统。我们证明 Neurosurgeon 显著改善了端到端延迟，降低了移动能耗，并提高了数据中心吞吐量。（第 5 节和第 6 节）

我们对一套 8 个 DNN 应用程序的评估表明，使用 Neurosurgeon 平均可将端到端延迟提高 3.1 $\times$ ，将移动能耗降低 59.5%，并将数据中心吞吐量提高 1.5 $\times$ 。

2. 背景

在本节中，我们将概述深度神经网络 (DNN)，并描述计算机视觉、语音和自然语言处理应用程序如何利用 DNN 作为其核心机器学习算法。

DNN 以有向图的形式组织，其中每个节点都是一个处理元素（神经元），它将函数应用于其输入并生成输出。图 2 描绘了 5 层

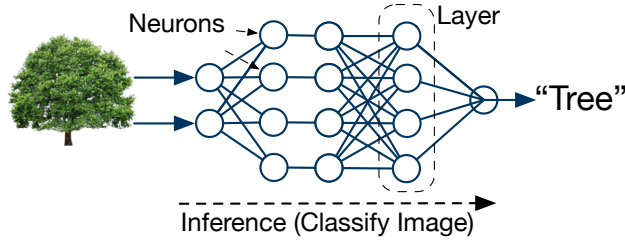


Figure 2: A 5-layer Deep Neural Network (DNN) classifies input image into one of the pre-defined classes.

DNN for image classification where computation flows from left to right. The edges of the graph are the connections between each neuron defining the flow of data. Multiple neurons applying the same function to different parts of the input define a layer. For a forward pass through a DNN, the output of a layer is the input to the next layer. The depth of a DNN is determined by the number of layers. Computer Vision (CV) applications use DNNs to extract features from an input image and classify the image into one of the pre-defined classes. Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) applications use DNNs to generate predictions for speech feature vectors, which will then be post-processed to produce the most-likely text transcript. Natural Language Processing (NLP) applications use DNNs to analyze and extract semantic and syntactic information from word embedding vectors generated from input text.

3. Cloud-only Processing: The Status Quo

Currently, the status quo approach used by cloud providers for intelligent applications is to perform all DNN processing in the cloud [10–13]. A large overhead of this approach is in sending data over the wireless network. In this section, we investigate the feasibility of executing large DNNs entirely on a state-of-the-art mobile device, and compare with the status quo.

3.1 Experimental setup

We use a real hardware platform, representative of today’s state-of-the-art mobile devices, the Jetson TK1 mobile platform developed by NVIDIA [16] and used in the Nexus 9 tablet [17]. The Jetson TK1 is equipped with one of NVIDIA’s latest mobile SoC, Tegra K1: a quad-core ARM A15 and a Kepler mobile GPU with a single streaming multiprocessor (Table 1).

Table 1: Mobile Platform Specifications

Hardware	Specifications
System	Tegra K1 SoC
CPU	4-Plus-1 quad-core ARM Cortex A15 CPU
Memory	2 GB DDR3L 933MHz
GPU	NVIDIA Kepler with 192 CUDA Cores

Table 2: Server Platform Specifications

Hardware	Specifications
System	4U Intel Dual CPU Chassis, 8 × PCIe 3.0 × 16 slots
CPU	2 × Intel Xeon E5-2620 V2, 6C, 2.10 GHz
HDD	1TB 2.5” HDD
Memory	16 × 16GB DDR3 1866MHz ECC/Server Memory
GPU	NVIDIA Tesla K40 M-Class 12 GB PCIe

Our server platform is equipped with an NVIDIA Tesla K40 GPU, one of NVIDIA’s latest offering in server class GPUs (Table 2).

We use Caffe [18], an actively developed open-source deep learning library, for the mobile and server platform. For the mobile CPU, we use OpenBLAS [19], a NEON-vectorized matrix multiplication library and use the 4 cores available. For both GPUs, we use cuDNN [20], an optimized NVIDIA library that accelerates key layers in Caffe, and use Caffe’s CUDA implementations for rest of the layers.

3.2 Examining the Mobile Edge

We investigate the capability of the mobile platform to execute a traditionally cloud-only DNN workload. We use AlexNet [21] as our application, a state-of-the-art Convolutional Neural Network for image classification. Prior work has noted that AlexNet is representative of today’s DNNs deployed in server environments [22].

In Figure 3, we break down the latency of an AlexNet query, a single inference on a 152KB image. For wireless communication, we measure the bandwidth of 3G, LTE, and Wi-Fi on several mobile devices using TestMyNet [23].

Communication Latency – Figure 3a shows the latency to upload the input image via 3G, LTE, and Wi-Fi. The slowest is 3G connection taking over 870ms. LTE and Wi-Fi connection require 180ms and 95ms to upload, respectively, showing that the network type is critical for achieving low latency for the status quo approach.

Computation Latency – Figure 3b shows the computation latency on mobile CPU, GPU and cloud GPU. The slowest platform is the mobile CPU taking 382ms to process while the mobile GPU and cloud GPU take 81ms and 6ms, respectively. Note that the mobile CPU’s time to process the image is still 2.3× faster than uploading input via 3G.

End-to-end Latency – Figure 3c shows the total latency required by the status quo and the mobile-only approach. Annotated on top of each bar is the fraction of the end-to-end latency spent on computation. The status quo approach spends less than 6% of the time computing on the server and over 94% of the time transferring data. The mobile GPU achieves a lower end-to-end latency than the status quo approach using LTE and 3G, while the status quo approach using LTE and Wi-Fi performs better than mobile CPU execution.

Energy Consumption – We measure the energy consumption of the mobile device using a Watts Up? meter [24] and

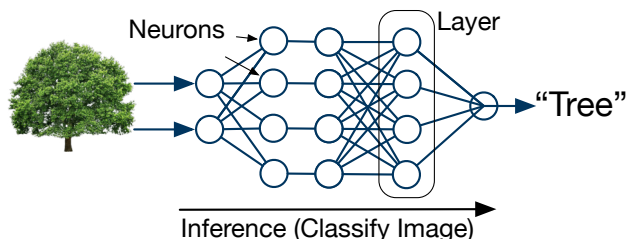


图 2：5 层深度神经网络 (DNN) 将输入图像分类为预定义类别之一。

用于图像分类的 DNN，其中计算从左到右流动。图的边是定义数据流的每个神经元之间的连接。将相同功能应用于输入的不同部分的多个神经元定义了一个层。对于通过 DNN 的前向传递，一层的输出是下一层的输入。DNN 的深度由层数决定。计算机视觉 (CV) 应用程序使用 DNN 从输入图像中提取特征，并将图像分类到预定义的类别之一。自动语音识别 (ASR) 应用程序使用 DNN 生成语音特征向量的预测，然后对其进行后续处理以生成最可能的文本转录。自然语言处理 (NLP) 应用程序使用 DNN 从输入文本生成的词嵌入向量中分析和提取语义和句法信息。

3. 纯云处理：现状

目前，云提供商用于智能应用程序的现状方法是在云中执行所有 DNN 处理[10-13]。这种方法的一大开销是通过无线网络发送数据。在本节中，我们将研究完全在最先进的移动设备上执行大型 DNN 的可行性，并与现状进行比较。

3.1 实验装置

我们使用真正的硬件平台，代表当今最先进的移动设备，即由 NVIDIA [16] 开发并用于 Nexus 9 平板电脑 [17] 的 Jetson TK1 移动平台。Jetson TK1 配备了 NVIDIA 最新的移动 SoC 之一 Tegra K1：四核 ARM A15 和带有单个流式多处理器的 Kepler 移动 GPU（表 1）。

表 1：移动平台规格

Hardware	Specifications
System	Tegra K1 SoC
CPU	4-Plus-1 quad-core ARM Cortex A15 CPU
Memory	2 GB DDR3L 933MHz
GPU	NVIDIA Kepler with 192 CUDA Cores

表 2：服务器平台规格

Hardware	Specifications
System	4U Intel Dual CPU Chassis, 8×PCIe 3.0×16 slots
CPU	2× Intel Xeon E5-2620 V2, 6C, 2.10 GHz
HDD	1TB 2.5" HDD
Memory	16× 16GB DDR3 1866MHz ECC/Server Memory
GPU	NVIDIA Tesla K40 M-Class 12 GB PCIe

我们的服务器平台配备了 NVIDIA Tesla K40 GPU，这是 NVIDIA 最新的服务器级 GPU 产品之一（表 2）。

我们使用 Caffe [18]，一个积极开发的开源深度学习库，用于移动和服务器平台。对于移动 CPU，我们使用 OpenBLAS [19]，这是一个 NEON 向量化矩阵乘法库，并使用 4 个可用核心。对于这两个 GPU，我们使用 cuDNN [20]，这是一个优化的 NVIDIA 库，可加速 Caffe 中的关键层，并使用 Caffe 的 CUDA 实现来处理其余层。

3.2 检查移动边缘

我们研究了移动平台执行传统的仅云 DNN 工作负载的能力。我们使用 AlexNet [21] 作为我们的应用程序，这是一种用于图像分类的最先进的卷积神经网络。之前的工作指出 AlexNet 是当今服务器环境中部署的 DNN 的代表 [22]。

在图 3 中，我们分解了 AlexNet 查询的延迟，即对 1 52KB 图像的单个推理。对于无线通信，我们使用 Test MyNet [23] 测量多个移动设备上的 3G、LTE 和 Wi-Fi 带宽。

通信延迟 - 图 3a 显示通过 3G、LTE 和 Wi-Fi 上传输入图像的延迟。最慢的是 3G 连接，需要 870 毫秒以上。LTE 和 Wi-Fi 连接分别需要 180 毫秒和 95 毫秒上传，这表明网络类型对于实现现有方法的低延迟至关重要。

计算延迟——图 3b 显示了移动 CPU、GPU 和云 GPU 上的计算延迟。最慢的平台是移动 CPU，需要 382 毫秒进行处理，而移动 GPU 和云 GPU 分别需要 81 毫秒和 6 毫秒。请注意，移动 CPU 处理图像的时间仍然比通过 3G 上传输入快 2.3×。

端到端延迟——图 3c 显示了现状和仅移动方法所需的总延迟。每个条形顶部注释的是用于计算的端到端延迟的比例。现状方法仅花费不到 6% 的时间在服务器上进行计算，而超过 94% 的时间用于传输数据。与使用 LTE 和 3G 的现状方法相比，移动 GPU 实现了更低的端到端延迟，而使用 LTE 和 Wi-Fi 的现状方法的性能优于移动 CPU 执行。

能源消耗 - 我们使用 Watts Up? 测量移动设备的能源消耗？米 [24] 和

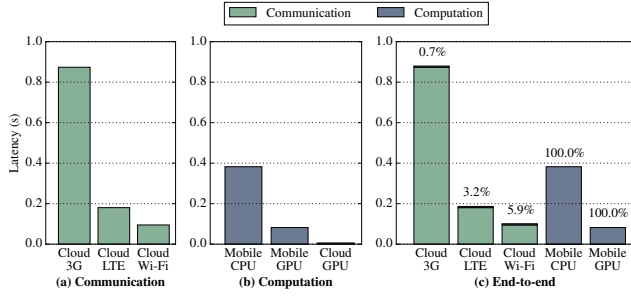


Figure 3: Latency breakdown for AlexNet (image classification). The cloud-only approach is often slower than mobile execution due to the high data transfer overhead.

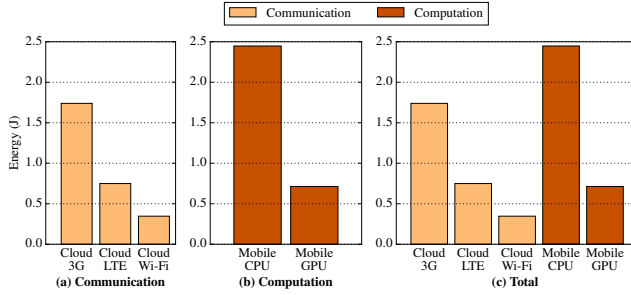


Figure 4: Mobile energy breakdown for AlexNet (image classification). Mobile device consumes more energy transferring data via LTE and 3G than computing locally on the GPU.

techniques described by Huang et al. [25]. Similar to the trends shown in Figure 3a, Figure 4a shows that the communication energy is heavily dependent on the type of wireless network used. In Figure 4b, the mobile device’s energy consumption is higher on the CPU than the GPU (while the GPU needs more power, the device is used for a shorter burst thus it consumes less total energy). Figure 4c shows the total mobile energy consumption for the cloud-only approach and mobile execution where the energy in the cloud-only approach is dominated by communication. The mobile GPU consumes less energy than transferring input via LTE or 3G for cloud processing, while cloud processing via Wi-Fi consumes less energy than mobile execution.

Key Observations – 1) The data transfer latency is often higher than mobile computation latency, especially on 3G and LTE. 2) Cloud processing has a significant computational advantage over mobile processing, but it does not always translate to end-to-end latency/energy advantage due to the dominating data transfer overhead. 3) Local mobile execution often leads to lower latency and energy consumption than the cloud-only approach, while the cloud-only approach achieves better performance if using fast Wi-Fi connection.

4. Fine-grained Computation Partitioning

Based on the findings in Section 3, the question arises as to whether it is advantageous to partition DNN computation between the mobile device and cloud. Based on the observation that DNN layers provide an abstraction suitable for partitioning computation, we begin with an analysis of the

data and computation characteristics of state-of-the-art DNN architectures at the layer granularity.

4.1 Layer Taxonomy

Before the layer-level analysis, it is important to understand the various types of layers present in today’s DNNs.

Fully-connected Layer (fc) – All the neurons in a fully-connected layer are exhaustively connected to all the neurons in the previous layer. The layer computes the weighted sum of the inputs using a set of learned weights.

Convolution & Local Layer (conv, local) – Convolution and local layers convolve the image with a set of learned filters to produce a set of feature maps. These layers mainly differ in the dimensions of their input feature maps, the number and size of their filters, and the stride with which the filters are being applied.

Pooling Layer (pool) – Pooling layers apply a pre-defined function (e.g., max or average) over regions of input feature maps to group features together. These layers mainly differ in the dimension of their input, size of the pooling region, and the stride with which the pooling is applied.

Activation Layer – Activation layers apply a non-linear function to each of its input data individually, producing the same amount of data as output. Activation layers present in the neural networks studied in this work include sigmoid layer (sig), rectified-linear layer (relu), and hard Tanh layer (htanh).

Other layers studied in this work include: **normalization layer (norm)** normalizes features across spatially grouped feature maps; **softmax layer (softmax)** produces a probability distribution over the number of possible classes for classification; **argmax layer (argmax)** chooses the class with the highest probability; and **dropout layer (dropout)** randomly ignores neurons during training to avoid model over-fitting and are passed through during prediction.

4.2 Characterizing Layers in AlexNet

We first investigate the data and computation characteristics of each layer in AlexNet. These characteristics provide insights to identify a better computation partitioning between mobile and cloud at the layer level. In the remainder of this and subsequent sections, we use the GPU in both mobile and server platforms.

Per-layer Latency – The left bars (light-colored) in Figure 5 show the latency of each layer on the mobile platform, arranged from left to right in their sequential execution order. The convolution (conv) and fully-connected layers (fc) are the most time-consuming layers, representing over 90% of the total execution time. Convolution layers in the middle (conv3 and conv4) takes longer to execute than the early convolution layers (conv1 and conv2). Larger number of filters are applied by the convolution layers later in the DNN to progressively extract more robust and representative fea-

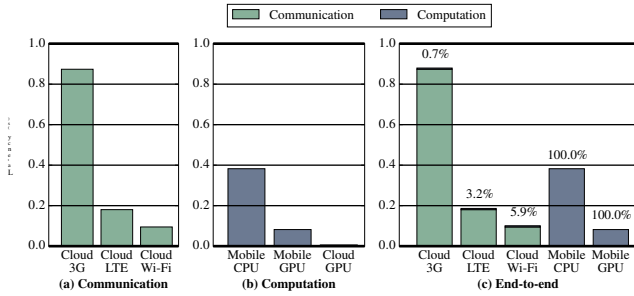


图 3: AlexNet 的延迟细分 (图像分类)。由于数据传输开销较高, 纯云方法通常比移动执行速度慢。

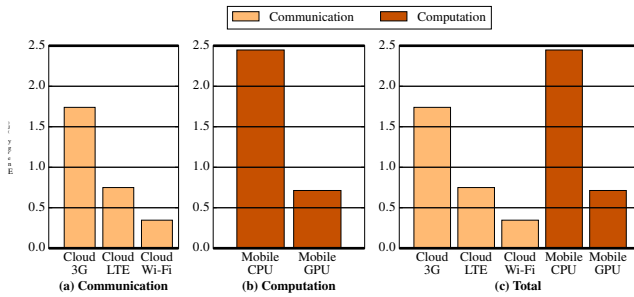


图 4: AlexNet 的移动能源细分 (图像分类)。移动设备通过 LTE 和 3G 传输数据比在 GPU 上本地计算消耗更多的能量。

黄等人描述的技术。[25]。与图 3a 中显示的趋势类似, 图 4a 显示通信能量在很大程度上取决于所使用的无线网络类型。在图 4b 中, 移动设备的 CPU 能耗高于 GPU (虽然 GPU 需要更多电量, 但设备使用的突发时间较短, 因此消耗的总能耗较少)。图 4c 显示了纯云方法和移动执行的总移动能耗, 其中纯云方法中的能量主要由通信决定。与通过 LTE 或 3G 传输输入进行云处理相比, 移动 GPU 消耗的能源更少, 而通过 Wi-Fi 进行的云处理比移动执行消耗的能源更少。

Key Observations – 1) 数据传输延迟通常高于移动计算延迟, 尤其是在 3G 和 LTE 上。2) 云处理比移动处理具有显着的计算优势, 但由于数据传输开销占主导地位, 它并不总是转化为端到端延迟/能源优势。3) 本地移动执行通常会比纯云方法带来更低的延迟和能耗, 而如果使用快速 Wi-Fi 连接, 纯云方法可以实现更好的性能。

4. 细粒度计算划分

根据第 3 节的发现, 出现了在移动设备和云之间划分 DNN 计算是否有利的问题。基于对 DNN 层提供适合分区计算的抽象的观察, 我们首先分析

最先进的 DNN 架构在层粒度上的数据和计算特征。

4.1 层分类

在进行层级分析之前, 了解当今 DNN 中存在的各种类型的层非常重要。

全连接层 (fc)——全连接层中的所有神经元都详尽地连接到前一层中的所有神经元。该层使用一组学习的权重计算输入的加权和。

卷积和局部层 (conv, local) - 卷积和局部层将图像与一组学习过滤器进行卷积, 以生成一组特征图。这些层的主要区别在于输入特征图的尺寸、滤波器的数量和大小以及应用滤波器的步幅。

池化层 (pool) - 池化层在输入特征图的区域上应用预定义的函数 (例如最大值或平均值), 以将特征分组在一起。这些层的主要区别在于输入的维度、池化区域的大小以及应用池化的步幅。

激活层——激活层将非线性函数分别应用于每个输入数据, 产生与输出相同数量的数据。这项工作中研究的神经网络中存在的激活层包括 sigmoid 层 (sig)、整流线性层 (relu) 和硬 Tanh 层 (htanh)。

这项工作中研究的其他层包括: 归一化层 (norm) 对空间分组特征图上的特征进行归一化; softmax 层 (softmax) 生成用于分类的可能类别数量的概率分布; argmax 层 (argmax) 选择概率最高的类; 丢失层 (dropout) 在训练期间随机忽略神经元以避免模型过度拟合, 并在预测期间通过。

4.2 AlexNet 中的特征层

我们首先研究 AlexNet 中每一层的数据和计算特征。这些特征为在层级别确定移动和云之间更好的计算划分提供了见解。在本节的其余部分和后续部分中, 我们在移动平台和服务器平台中使用 GPU。

每层延迟 - 图 5 中的左侧条形图 (浅色) 显示移动平台上每一层的延迟, 按顺序执行顺序从左到右排列。卷积层 (conv) 和全连接层 (fc) 是最耗时的层, 占总执行时间的 90% 以上。中间的卷积层 (conv3 和 conv4) 比早期的卷积层 (conv1 和 conv2) 需要更长的执行时间。DNN 中的卷积层稍后会应用更多数量的滤波器, 以逐步提取更稳健和更具代表性的特征。

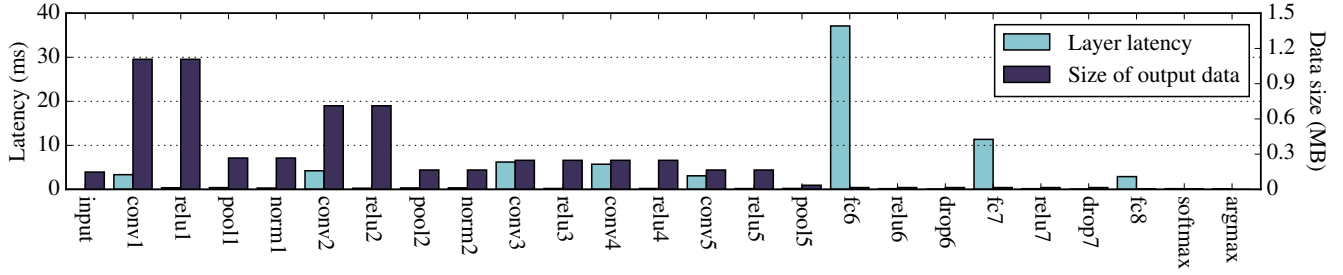


Figure 5: The per layer execution time (the light-colored left bar) and size of data (the dark-colored right bar) after each layer's execution (input for next layer) in AlexNet. Data size sharply increases then decreases while computation generally increases through the network's execution.

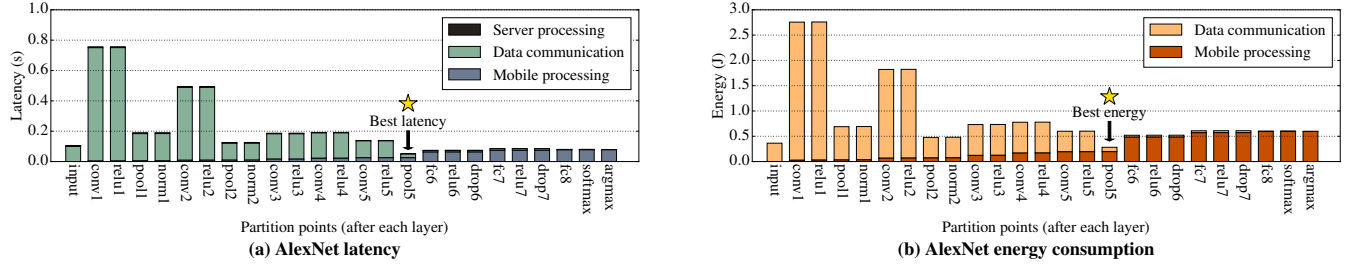


Figure 6: End-to-end latency and mobile energy consumption when choosing different partition points. After the execution of every layer is considered a partition point. Each bar represents the total latency (a) or mobile energy (b) if the DNN is partitioned after the layer marked on the X-axis. The left-most bar represents cloud-only processing and the right-most bar represents mobile-only processing. The partition points for best latency and mobile energy are annotated.

tures, increasing the amount of computation. On the other hand, fully-connected layers are up to one magnitude slower than the convolution layers in the network. The most time-consuming layer is the layer `fc6`, a fully-connected layer deep in the DNN, taking 45% of the total execution time.

Data Size Variations – The right bars (dark-colored) in Figure 5 shows the size of each layer's output data, which is also the input to the next layer. The first three convolution layers (`conv1`, `conv2` and `conv3`) generate large amounts of output data (shown as the largest dark bars) as they apply hundreds of filters over their input feature maps to extract interesting features. The data size stays constant through the activation layers (`relu1` - `relu5`). The pooling layers sharply reduce the data size by up to $4.7\times$ as they summarize regions of neighboring features by taking the maximum. The fully-connected layers deeper in the network (`fc6` - `fc8`) gradually reduce the data size until the softmax layer (`softmax`) and `argmax` layer (`argmax`) at the end reduce the data to be one classification label.

Key Observations – 1) Depending on its type and location in the network, each layer has a different computation and data profile. 2) The latency of convolution and pooling layers on the mobile GPU are relatively small, while fully-connected layers incur high latency. 3) Convolution and pooling layers are mostly at the front-end of the network, while fully-connected layers are at the back-end. 4) With convolution layers increasing data and then pooling layers reducing data, the front-end layers altogether reduce the size of data gradually. Data size in the last few layers are smaller than the original input. 5) The findings that data size is generally decreases

ing at the front-end, and per-layer mobile latency is generally higher at the back-end, indicates the unique opportunity for computation partitioning in the middle of the DNN between the mobile and cloud.

4.3 Layer-granularity Computation Partitioning

The analysis in Section 4.2 indicates that there exist interesting points within a neural network to partition computation. In this section, we explore partitioning AlexNet at each layer between the mobile and cloud. In this section, we use Wi-Fi as the wireless network configuration.

Each bar in Figure 6a represents the end-to-end latency of AlexNet, partitioned after each layer. Similarly, each bar in Figure 6b represents the mobile energy consumption of Alexnet, partitioned after each layer. Partitioning computation after a specific layer means executing the DNN on the mobile up to that layer, transferring the output of that layer to the cloud via wireless network, and executing the remaining layers in the cloud. The leftmost bar represents sending the original input for cloud-only processing. As partition point moves from left to right, more layers are executed on the mobile device thus there is an increasingly larger mobile processing component. The rightmost bar is the latency of executing the entire DNN locally on the mobile device.

Partition for Latency – If partitioning at the front-end, the data transfer dominates the end-to-end latency, which is consistent with our observation in Section 4.2 that the data size is the largest at the early stage of the DNN. Partitioning at the back-end provides better performance since the application can minimize the data transfer overhead, while taking ad-

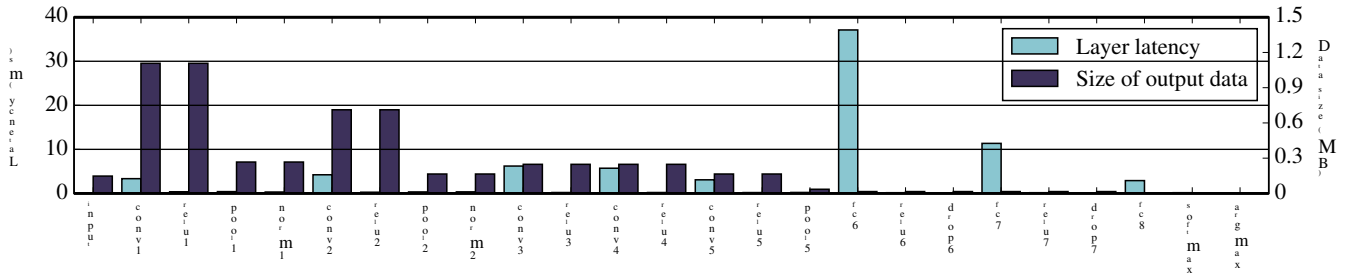


图 5：每层执行后的每层执行时间（浅色左侧条）和数据大小（深色右侧条）（输入 AlexNet 中的下一层）。数据大小急剧增加然后减少，而计算量通常通过网络的执行而增加。为了

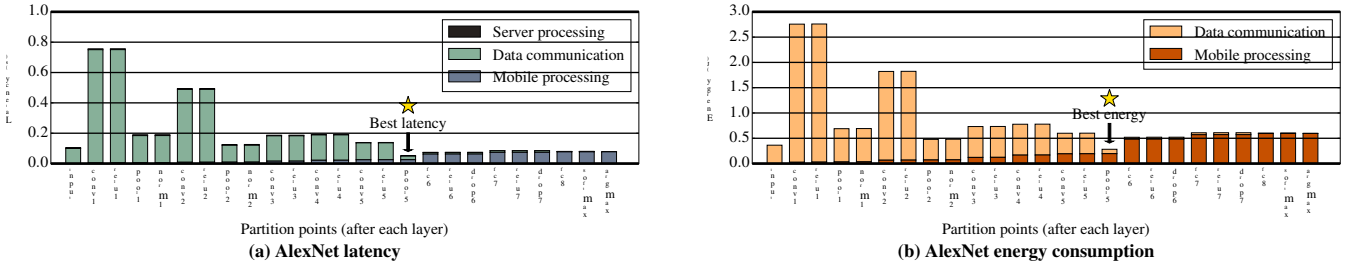


图 6：选择不同分区点时的端到端延迟和移动能耗。每一层执行后都被认为是一个分区点。如果 DNN 在 X 轴上标记的层之后进行分区，则每个条形代表总延迟 (a) 或移动能量 (b)。最左边的条代表仅限云处理，最右边的条代表仅限移动处理。注释了最佳延迟和移动能量的划分点。

的情况，增加了计算量。另一方面，全连接层比网络中的卷积层慢一个数量级。最耗时的层是层 fc6，它是 DNN 深处的全连接层，占用总执行时间的 45%。

数据大小变化——图 5 中的右侧条（深色）显示了每层输出数据的大小，这也是下一层的输入。前三个卷积层（conv1、conv2 和 conv3）在输入特征图上应用数百个过滤器以提取有趣的特征时，会生成大量输出数据（显示为最大的黑条）。数据大小在激活层（relu1 - relu5）中保持恒定。池化层通过取最大值来总结相邻特征的区域，从而将数据大小急剧减少高达 4.7 $\times$ 。网络较深处的全连接层（fc6 - fc8）逐渐减少数据大小，直到最后的 softmax 层（softmax）和 argmax 层（argmax）将数据减少为一个分类标签。

Key Observations – 1) 根据其类型和在网络中的位置，每一层都有不同的计算和数据配置文件。2) 移动 GPU 上的卷积层和池化层的延迟相对较小，而全连接层的延迟较高。3) 卷积层和池化层大多位于网络的前端，而全连接层则位于后端。4) 随着卷积层增加数据，然后池化层减少数据，前端层逐渐减少数据大小。最后几层的数据大小小于原始输入。5) 数据大小普遍减少的结果

前端的每层移动延迟通常较高，这表明在移动和云之间的 DNN 中间进行计算分区的独特机会。

4.3 层粒度计算划分

4.2 节中的分析表明，神经网络中存在一些有趣的点来划分计算。在本节中，我们将探讨在移动设备和云之间的每一层对 AlexNet 进行分区。在本节中，我们使用 Wi-Fi 作为无线网络配置。

图 6a 中的每个条形代表 AlexNet 的端到端延迟，在每一层之后进行分区。类似地，图 6b 中的每个条形代表 Alexnet 的移动能耗，在每一层之后进行划分。在特定层之后进行分区计算意味着在移动设备上执行 DNN 直到该层，通过无线网络将该层的输出传输到云端，并在云端执行其余层。最左边的条代表发送原始输入以进行仅云处理。随着分区点从左向右移动，在移动设备上执行更多层，因此移动处理组件越来越大。最右边的条是在移动设备上本地执行整个 DNN 的延迟。

延迟分区——如果在前端分区，则数据传输主导端到端延迟，这与我们在 4.2 节中观察到的数据大小在 DNN 早期阶段最大的情况一致。后端分区提供了更好的性能，因为应用程序可以最大限度地减少数据传输开销，同时采取 ad-

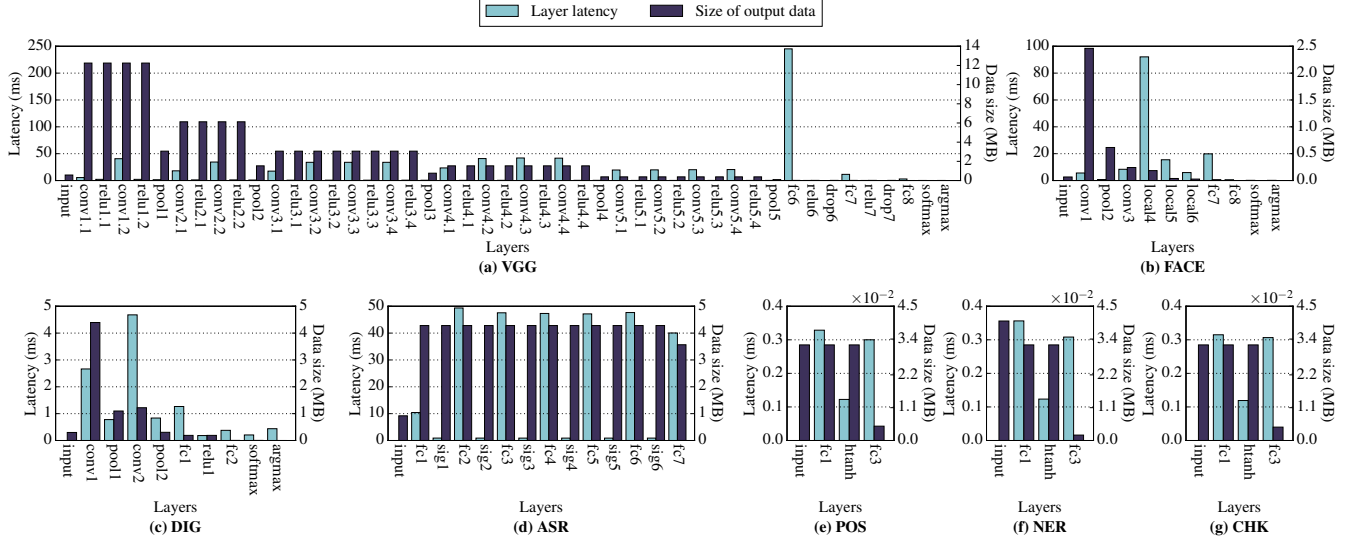


Figure 7: The per layer latency on the mobile GPU (left light-color bar) and size of data (right dark-color bar) after each layer’s execution.

vantage of the powerful server to execute the more compute-heavy layers at the back-end. In the case of AlexNet using the mobile GPU and Wi-Fi, partitioning between the last pooling layer (pool5) and the first fully-connected layer (fc6) achieves the lowest latency, as marked in Figure 6a, improving 2.0× over cloud-only processing.

Partition for Energy – Similar to latency, due to the high energy cost of wireless data transfer, transferring the input for cloud-only processing is not the most energy-efficiency approach. As marked in Figure 6b, partitioning in the middle of the DNN achieves the best mobile energy consumption, 18% more energy efficient than the cloud-only approach.

Key Observations – Partitioning at the layer granularity can provide significant latency and energy efficiency improvements. For AlexNet using the GPU and Wi-Fi, the best partition points are between the intermediate layers of the DNN.

4.4 Generalizing to More DNNs

We expand our investigation to 7 more intelligent applications to study their data and computation characteristics and their impact on computation partitioning opportunity. We use the DNNs provided in the Tonic suite [9], as well as VGG, a state-of-the-art image classification DNN, and LTE as the wireless network configuration. Details about the benchmarks are listed in Table 3. We count the number of layers of each DNN starting from the first non-input layer to the last layer, including argmax if present.

CV Applications – The three remaining computer vision DNNs (VGG, FACE and DIG) have similar characteristics as AlexNet (Figure 5), as shown in Figures 7a–7c. The front-end layers are convolution layers increasing data, and pooling layers reducing data. The data size in the back-end layers are similar or smaller than the original input data. The latency for the back-end layers are higher than most of the

Table 3: Benchmark Specifications

App	Abbr.	Network	Input	Layers
Image classification	IMC	AlexNet [21]	Image	24
	VGG	VGG [26]	Image	46
Facial recognition	FACE	DeepFace [27]	Image	10
Digit recognition	DIG	MNIST [28]	Image	9
Speech recognition	ASR	Kaldi [29]	Speech features	13
Part-of-speech tagging	POS	SENNA [30]	Word vectors	3
Named entity recognition	NER	SENNA [30]	Word vectors	3
Word chunking	CHK	SENNA [30]	Word vectors	3

front-end layers (e.g., fc6 is the most time-consuming layer in VGG), except for DIG where convolution layers are most time-consuming. Similar to AlexNet, these characteristics indicate partitioning opportunities in the middle of the DNN. Figure 8a shows that the partition point for best latency for VGG is in the intermediate layers. In addition, Figures 8a - 8c show that different CV applications have different partition points for best latency, and Figures 9a - 9c show the different partition points for best energy for these DNNs.

ASR and NLP Applications – The remaining four DNNs in the suite (ASR, POS, NER and CHK) only consist of fully-connected layers and activation layers. The layer breakdowns are shown in Figures 7d - 7g, where, throughout the execution, layers of the same type incur similar latency and the data size stay relatively constant except for the very first and last layer of each DNN. These DNNs do not have data-increasing layers (i.e., convolution layers) or data-reducing layers (i.e., pooling layers). As a result, there only exist opportunities for partitioning the computation at the extremities of these networks. Figures 8d - 8g and Figures 9d - 9g show the different partition points for best latency and energy for these DNNs, respectively. There are data communication components in the right-most bars (mobile-only processing) for these applications because the output of the DNN is sent to the cloud for post-processing steps required by these applications.

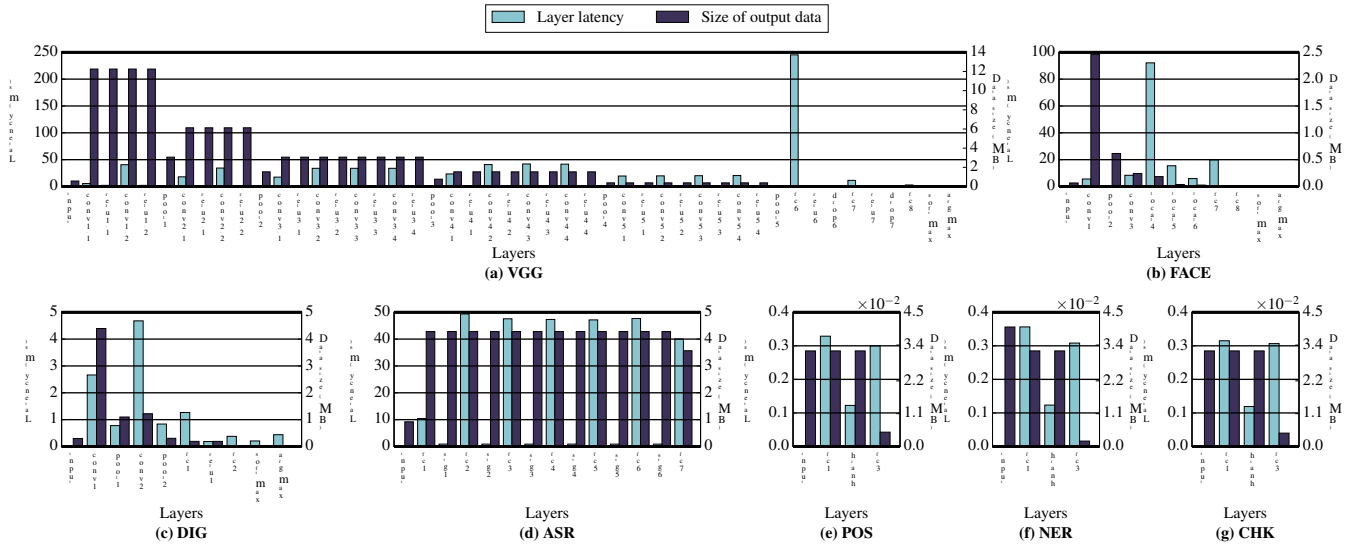


图 7：每层执行后移动 GPU 上的每层延迟（左侧浅色条）和数据大小（右侧深色条）。

利用强大的服务器在后端执行计算量更大的层。在 AlexNet 使用移动 GPU 和 Wi-Fi 的情况下，最后一个池化层 (poo15) 和第一个全连接层 (fc6) 之间的分区实现了最低延迟，如图 6a 所示，与纯云处理相比提高了 2.0 ×。

能源分区——与延迟类似，由于无线数据传输的能源成本很高，传输输入仅用于云处理并不是最节能的方法。如图 6b 所示，在 DNN 中间进行分区可实现最佳的移动能耗，比纯云方法节能 18%。

Key Observations – 层粒度的分区可以显著提高延迟和能源效率。对于使用 GPU 和 Wi-Fi 的 AlexNet，最佳划分点位于 DNN 的中间层之间。

4.4 推广到更多的 DNN

我们将调查范围扩大到 7 个更智能的应用程序，以研究它们的数据和计算特性以及它们对计算分区机会的影响。我们使用 Tonic 套件 [9] 中提供的 DNN，以及 VGG（一种最先进的图像分类 DNN）和 LTE 作为无线网络配置。表 3 列出了有关基准的详细信息。我们计算每个 DNN 的层数，从第一个非输入层到最后一层，包括 argmax（如果存在）。

CV 应用——剩下的三个计算机视觉 DNN（VGG、FACE 和 DIG）与 AlexNet（图 5）具有相似的特征，如图 7a–7c 所示。前端层是增加数据的卷积层和减少数据的池化层。后端层的数据大小与原始输入数据相似或较小。后端层的延迟高于大多数层的延迟

表 3：基准规格

App	Abbr.	Network	Input	Layers
Image classification	IMC	AlexNet [21]	Image	24
	VGG	VGG [26]	Image	46
Facial recognition	FACE	DeepFace [27]	Image	10
Digit recognition	DIG	MNIST [28]	Image	9
Speech recognition	ASR	Kaldi [29]	Speech features	13
Part-of-speech tagging	POS	SENNA [30]	Word vectors	3
Named entity recognition	NER	SENNA [30]	Word vectors	3
Word chunking	CHK	SENNA [30]	Word vectors	3

前端层（例如，fc6 是 VGG 中最耗时的层），但 DIG 除外，其中卷积层最耗时。与 AlexNet 类似，这些特征表明 DNN 中间的分区机会。图 8a 显示 VGG 最佳延迟的划分点位于中间层。此外，图 8a - 8c 显示不同的 CV 应用程序具有不同的最佳延迟划分点，图 9a - 9c 显示了这些 DNN 的最佳能量的不同划分点。

ASR 和 NLP 应用——套件中的其余四个 DNN（ASR、POS、NER 和 CHK）仅由全连接层和激活层组成。层分解如图 7d - 7g 所示，其中在整个执行过程中，相同类型的层会产生类似的延迟，并且除了每个 DNN 的第一层和最后一层之外，数据大小保持相对恒定。这些 DNN 没有数据增加层（即卷积层）或数据减少层（即池化层）。因此，只存在在这些网络的末端划分计算的机会。图 8d - 8g 和图 9d - 9g 分别显示了这些 DNN 的最佳延迟和能量的不同划分点。最右边的栏中有这些应用程序的数据通信组件（仅限移动设备处理），因为 DNN 的输出被发送到云端以进行这些应用程序所需的后处理步骤。

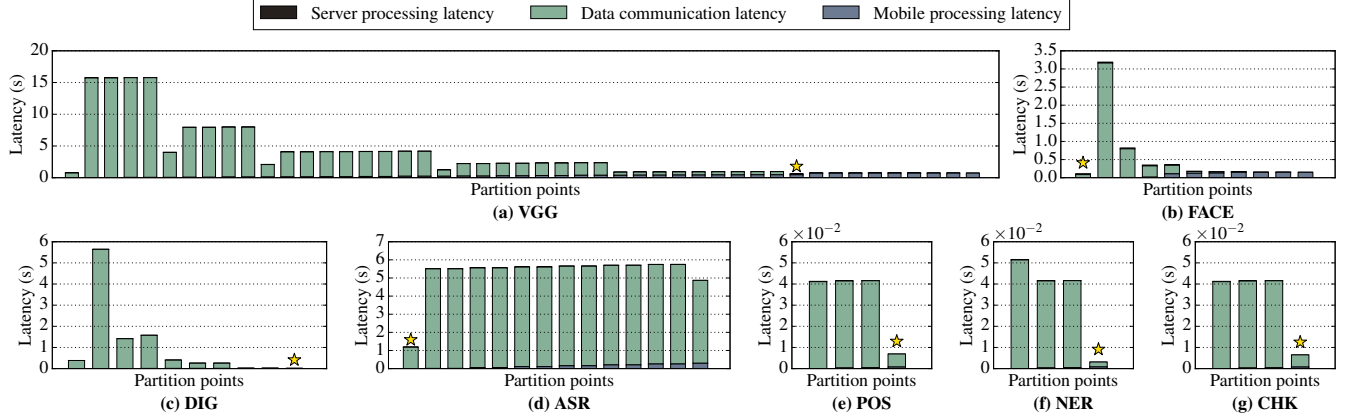


Figure 8: End-to-end latency when choosing different partition points. Each bar represents the end-to-end latency if the DNN is partitioned after each layer, where the left-most bar represents cloud-only processing (i.e., partitioning at the beginning) while the right-most bar represents mobile-only execution (i.e., partitioning at the end). The wireless network configuration is LTE. The partition points for best latency are each marked by ★.

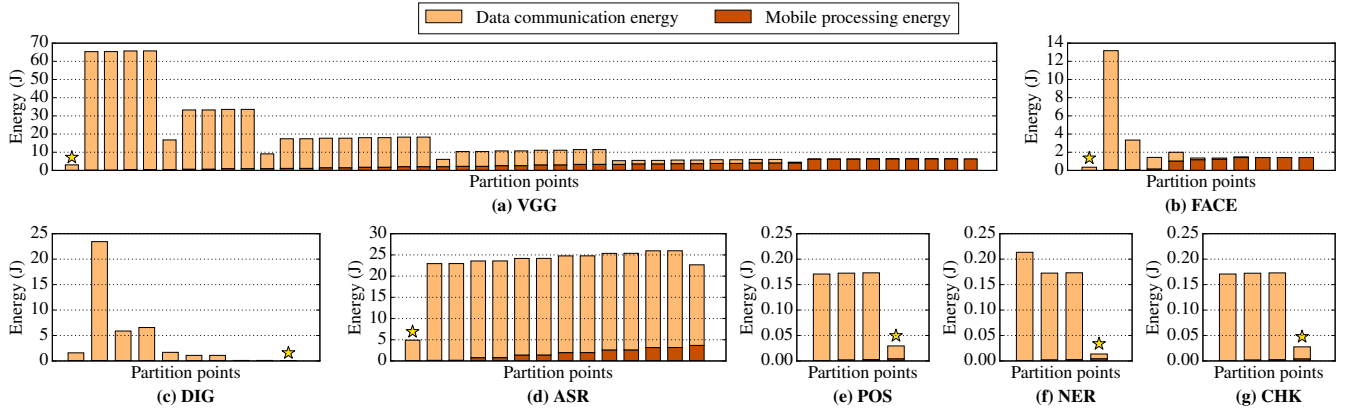


Figure 9: Mobile energy consumption when choosing different partition points. Each bar represents the mobile energy consumption if the DNN is partitioned after each layer, where the left-most bar represents cloud-only processing (i.e., partitioning at the beginning) while the right-most bar represents mobile-only execution (i.e., partitioning at the end). The wireless network configuration is LTE. The partition points for best energy are each marked by ★.

Key Observations – 1) In DNNs with convolution and pooling layers (e.g. Computer Vision applications), the data size increases after convolution layers and decreases after pooling layers, while the per-layer computation generally increases through the execution. 2) DNNs with only fully-connected layers of similar size and activation layers see small variations in per-layer latency and data size (e.g., ASR and NLP DNNs). 3) The best way to partition a DNN depends on its topology and constituent layers. Computer vision DNNs sometimes have better partition points in the middle of the DNN, while it is more beneficial to partition at the beginning or the end for ASR and NLP DNNs. The strong variations in the best partition point suggest there is a need for a system to partition DNN computation between the mobile and cloud based on the neural network architecture.

5. Neurosurgeon

The best partition point for a DNN architecture depends on the DNN’s topology, which manifests itself in the computation and data size variations of each layer. In addition, dy-

namic factors such as state of the wireless network and datacenter load affect the best partition point even for the same DNN architecture. For example, mobile devices’ wireless connections often experience high variances [31], directly affecting the data transfer latency. Datacenters typically experience diurnal load patterns [32], leading to high variance in its DNN query service time. Due to these dynamic factors, there is a need for an automatic system to intelligently select the best point to partition the DNN to optimize for end-to-end latency or mobile device energy consumption. To address this need, we present the design of Neurosurgeon, an intelligent DNN partitioning engine. Neurosurgeon consists of a deployment phase and a runtime system that manages the partitioned execution of an intelligent application. Figure 10 shows the design of Neurosurgeon, which has two stages: deployment and runtime.

At Deployment – Neurosurgeon profiles the mobile device and the server to generate performance prediction models for the spectrum of DNN layer types (enumerated in Section 4.1). Note that Neurosurgeon’s profiling is application

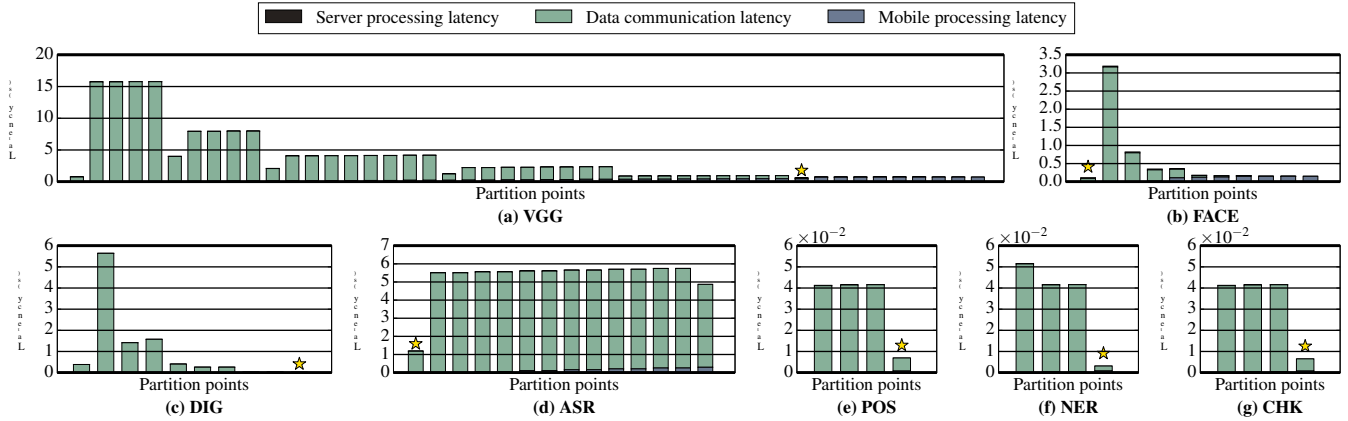


图8：选择不同分区点时的端到端延迟。如果 DNN 在每一层之后进行分区，则每个条形代表端到端延迟，其中最左边的条形代表仅云处理（即开始时的分区），而最右边的条形代表仅移动执行（即最后的分区）。无线网络配置为 LTE。最佳延迟的划分点均由 ★ 标记。

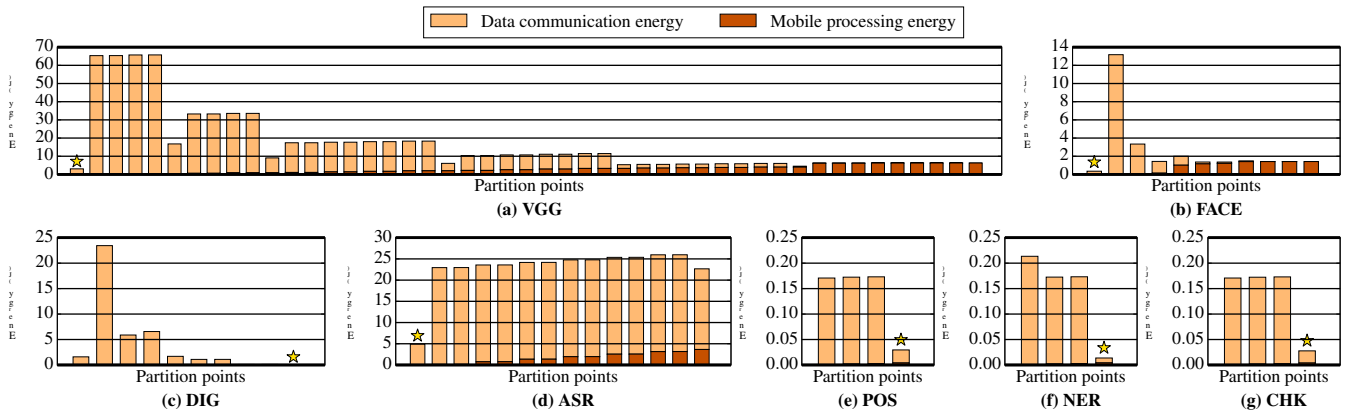


图9：选择不同分区点时的移动能耗。如果 DNN 在每一层之后进行分区，则每个条形代表移动能耗，其中最左边的条形代表仅云处理（即开始时的分区），而最右侧的条形代表仅移动执行（即最后的分区）。无线网络配置为 LTE。最佳能量的划分点分别用 ★ 标记。

Key Observations – 1) 在具有卷积层和池化层的DNN中（例如计算机视觉应用），数据大小在卷积层之后增加，在池化层之后减少，而每层计算量通常在执行过程中增加。2) 仅具有相似大小和激活层的全连接层的 DNN 在每层延迟和数据大小方面存在微小变化（例如，ASR 和 NLP DNN）。3) 划分 DNN 的最佳方法取决于其拓扑和组成层。计算机视觉 DNN 有时在 DNN 中间有更好的划分点，而对于 ASR 和 NLP DNN 在开头或结尾进行划分更为有利。最佳划分点的巨大变化表明，需要一个系统根据神经网络架构在移动端和云端之间划分 DNN 计算。

5. 神经外科医生

DNN 架构的最佳划分点取决于 DNN 的拓扑，这体现在每层的计算和数据大小变化上。此外，dy-

即使对于相同的 DNN 架构，无线网络状态和数据中心负载等自然因素也会影响最佳划分点。例如，移动设备的无线连接经常会遇到很大的差异[31]，直接影响数据传输延迟。数据中心通常会经历昼夜负载模式[32]，导致其 DNN 查询服务时间存在很大差异。由于这些动态因素，需要一个自动系统来智能地选择划分 DNN 的最佳点，以优化端到端延迟或移动设备能耗。为了满足这一需求，我们提出了智能 DNN 分区引擎

Neurosurgeon 的设计。Neurosurgeon 由部署阶段和管理智能应用程序的分区执行的运行时系统组成。图 10 显示了 Neurosurgeon 的设计，它有两个阶段：部署和运行时。

在部署时 - Neurosurgeon 分析移动设备和服务器，以生成 DNN 层类型范围的性能预测模型（第 4.1 节中列举）。请注意，Neurosurgeon 的分析是应用程序

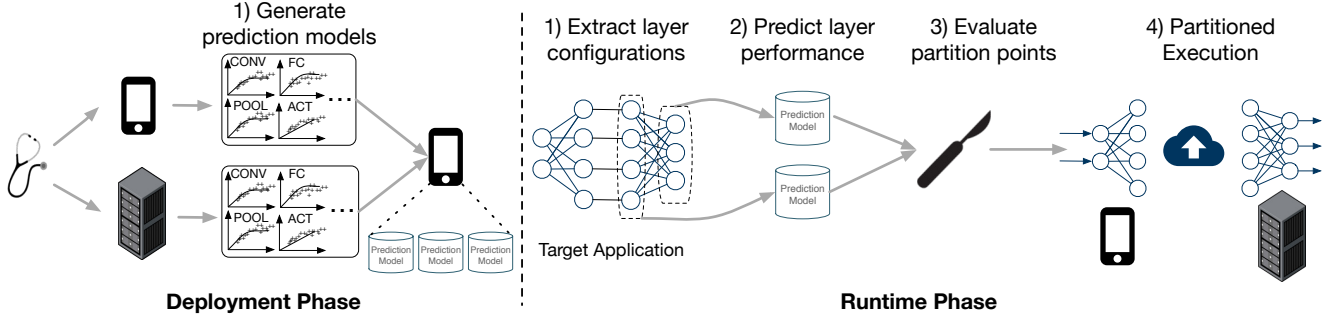


Figure 10: Overview of Neurosurgeon. At deployment, Neurosurgeon generates prediction models for each layer type. During runtime, Neurosurgeon predicts each layer’s latency/energy cost based on the layer’s type and configuration, and selects the best partition point based on various dynamic factors.

agnostic and only needs to be done once for a given set of mobile and server platforms; per-application profiling is not needed. This set of prediction models are stored on the mobile device and later used to predict the latency and energy cost of each layer (Section 5.1).

During Runtime – During the execution of an DNN-based intelligent application on the mobile device, Neurosurgeon dynamically decides the best partition point for the DNN. As illustrated in Figure 10, the steps are as follows: 1) Neurosurgeon analyzes and extracts the DNN architecture’s layer types and configurations; 2) the system uses the stored layer performance prediction models to estimate the latency and energy consumption for executing each layer on the mobile and cloud; 3) with these predictions, combined with the current wireless connection bandwidth and data-center load level, Neurosurgeon selects the best partition point, optimizing for best end-to-end latency or best mobile energy consumption; 4) Neurosurgeon executes the DNN, partitioning work between the mobile and cloud.

5.1 Performance Prediction Model

Neurosurgeon models the per-layer latency and the energy consumption of arbitrary neural network architecture. This approach allows Neurosurgeon to estimate the latency and energy consumption of a DNN’s constituent layers without executing the DNN.

We observe that for each layer type, there is a large latency variation across layer configurations. Thus, to construct the prediction model for each layer type, we vary the configurable parameters of the layer and measure the latency and power consumption for each configuration. Using these profiles, we establish a regression model for each layer type to predict the latency and power of the layer based on its configuration. We describe each layer’s regression model variables later in this section. We use GFLOPS (Giga Floating Point Operations per Second) as our performance metric. Based on the layer type, we use either a logarithmic or linear function as the regression function. The logarithmic-based regression is used to model the performance plateau as the computation requirement of the layer approaches the limit of the available hardware resources.

Convolution, local and pooling layers’ configurable parameters include the input feature map dimension, number, size and stride of the filters. The regression model for convolution layer is based on two variables: the number of features in the input feature maps, and $(filter\ size/stride)^2 \times (\#\ of\ filters)$, which represents the amount of computation applied to each pixel in the input feature maps. For local and pooling layers, we use the size of the input and output feature maps as the regression model variables.

In a **fully-connected** layer, the input data is multiplied by the learned weight matrix to generate the output vector. We use the number of input neurons and number of output neurons as the regression model variables. **Softmax** and **argmax** layers are handled similarly.

Activation layers have fewer configurable parameters compared to other layers because activation layers have a one-to-one mapping between their input data and output. We use the number of neurons as the regression model variable. We apply the same approach to **normalization** layers.

As previously mentioned, it is a one-time profiling step required for each mobile and server hardware platform to generate a set of prediction models. The models enable Neurosurgeon to estimate the latency and energy cost of each layer based its configuration, which allows Neurosurgeon to support future neural network architectures without additional profiling overhead.

5.2 Dynamic DNN Partitioning

Utilizing the layer performance prediction models, Neurosurgeon dynamically selects the best DNN partition points, as described in Algorithm 1. The algorithm has two-steps: analysis of the target DNN and partition point selection.

Analysis of the Target DNN – Neurosurgeon analyzes the target DNN’s constituent layers, and uses the prediction models to estimate, for each layer, the latency on mobile and cloud, and power consumption on the mobile. Specifically, at lines 11 and 12 of Algorithm 1, Neurosurgeon extracts each layer’s type and configuration (L_i) and uses the regression models to predict the latency of executing layer L_i on

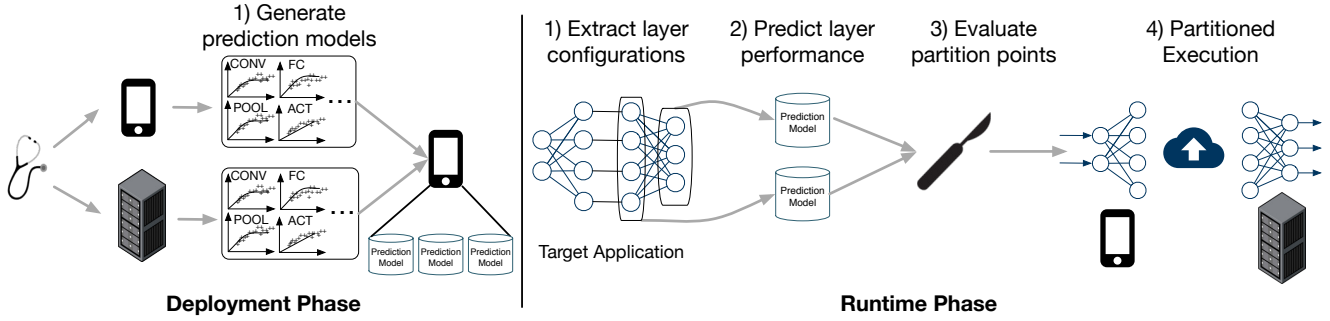


图 10: Neurosurgeon 概述。在部署时, Neurosurgeon 为每个层类型生成预测模型。在运行时, Neurosurgeon 根据层的类型和配置预测每层的延迟/能量成本, 并根据各种动态因素选择最佳划分点。

不可知论, 对于一组给定的移动和服务平台只需执行一次; 不需要每个应用程序分析。这组预测模型存储在移动设备上, 随后用于预测每层的延迟和能源成本 (第 5.1 节)。

运行时期间 – 在移动设备上执行基于 DNN 的智能应用程序期间, Neurosurgeon 动态决定 DNN 的最佳划分点。如图10所示, 步骤如下: 1) Neurosurgeon分析并提取DNN架构的层类型和配置; 2) 系统使用存储的层性能预测模型来估计在移动设备和云上执行每一层的延迟和能耗; 3) 根据这些预测, 结合当前的无线连接带宽和数据中心负载水平, Neurosurgeon选择最佳划分点, 优化最佳端到端延迟或最佳移动能耗; 4) Neurosurgeon 执行 DNN, 在移动设备和云端之间划分工作。

5.1 性能预测模型

Neurosurgeon 对任意神经网络架构的每层延迟和能耗进行建模。这种方法允许 Neurosurgeon 在不执行 DNN 的情况下估计 DNN 组成层的延迟和能耗。

我们观察到, 对于每种层类型, 层配置之间存在很大的延迟变化。因此, 为了构建每个层类型的预测模型, 我们改变层的可配置参数并测量每个配置的延迟和功耗。使用这些配置文件, 我们为每个层类型建立一个回归模型, 以根据其配置来预测该层的延迟和功率。我们将在本节后面描述每一层的回归模型变量。我们使用 G FLOPS (每秒千兆浮点运算) 作为我们的性能指标。根据图层类型, 我们使用对数函数或线性函数作为回归函数。当层的计算要求接近可用硬件资源的限制时, 基于对数的回归用于对性能平台进行建模。

卷积层、局部层和池化层的可配置参数包括输入特征图维度、滤波器的数量、大小和步长。卷积层的回归模型基于两个变量: 输入特征图中的特征数量, 以及 $(filter\ size/stride)^2 \times (\# of\ filters)$, 它表示应用于输入特征图中每个像素的计算量。对于局部层和池化层, 我们使用输入和输出特征图的大小作为回归模型变量。

在全连接层中, 输入数据乘以学习的权重矩阵以生成输出向量。我们使用输入神经元的数量和输出神经元的数量作为回归模型变量。Softmax 和 argmax 层的处理方式类似。

与其他层相比, 激活层的可配置参数较少, 因为激活层的输入数据和输出之间具有一对一的映射。我们使用神经元的数量作为回归模型变量。我们对标准化层应用相同的方法。

如前所述, 每个移动和服务平台都需要一次性分析步骤来生成一组预测模型。这些模型使 Neurosurgeon 能够根据其配置来估计每层的延迟和能量成本, 这使得 Neurosurgeon 能够支持未来的神经网络架构, 而无需额外的分析开销。

5.2 动态DNN分区

利用层性能预测模型, Neurosurgeon 动态选择最佳 DNN 划分点, 如算法 1 中所述。该算法有两个步骤: 目标 DNN 分析和划分点选择。

目标 DNN 分析 – Neurosurgeon 分析目标 DNN 的组成层, 并使用预测模型来估计每一层的移动和云延迟以及移动设备的功耗。具体来说, 在算法 1 的第 11 行和第 12 行, Neurosurgeon 提取每个层的类型和配置 (L_i), 并使用回归模型来预测执行层 L_i 的延迟。

Table 4: Neurosurgeon’s partition point selections for best end-to-end latency. Green block indicates Neurosurgeon makes the optimal partition choice and white block means a suboptimal partition point is picked. On average, Neurosurgeon achieves within 98.5% of the optimal performance.

Mobile	Wireless network	Benchmarks							
		IMC	VGG	FACE	DIG	ASR	POS	NER	CHK
CPU	Wi-Fi	input	input	input	input	input	fc3		
	LTE	input	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	3G	argmax	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
GPU	Wi-Fi	pool5	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	LTE	argmax	argmax	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	3G	argmax	argmax	argmax	argmax	input	fc3		

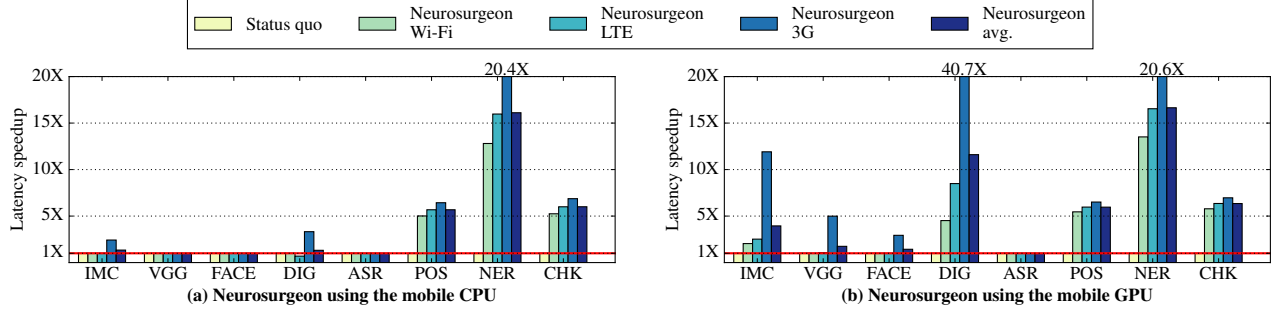


Figure 11: Latency speedup achieved by Neurosurgeon normalized to status quo approach (executing entire DNN in the cloud). Results for three wireless networks (Wi-Fi, LTE and 3G) and mobile CPU and GPU are shown here. Neurosurgeon improves the end-to-end DNN inference latency by $3.1\times$ on average (geometric mean) and up to $40.7\times$.

mobile (TM_i) and cloud (TC_i), while taking into consideration of current datacenter load level (K). Line 13 estimates the power of executing layer L_i on the mobile device (PM_i) and line 14 calculates the wireless data transfer latency (TU_i) based on the latest wireless network bandwidth.

Partition Point Selection – Neurosurgeon then selects the best partition point. The candidate points are after each layer. Lines 16 and 18 evaluate the performance when partitioning at each candidate point and select the point for either best end-to-end latency or best mobile energy consumption. Because of the simplicity of the regression models, this evaluation is lightweight and efficient.

Algorithm 1 Neurosurgeon DNN partitioning algorithm

```

1: Input:
2:  $N$ : number of layers in the DNN
3:  $\{L_i | i = 1 \dots N\}$ : layers in the DNN
4:  $\{D_i | i = 1 \dots N\}$ : data size at each layer
5:  $f, g(L_i)$ : regression models predicting the latency and power of executing  $L_i$ 
6:  $K$ : current datacenter load level
7:  $B$ : current wireless network uplink bandwidth
8:  $PU$ : wireless network uplink power consumption
9: procedure PARTITIONDECISION
10:   for each  $i$  in  $1 \dots N$  do
11:      $TM_i \leftarrow f_{mobile}(L_i)$ 
12:      $TC_i \leftarrow f_{cloud}(L_i, K)$ 
13:      $PM_i \leftarrow g_{mobile}(L_i)$ 
14:      $TU_i \leftarrow D_i/B$ 
15:   if  $OptTarget == latency$  then
16:     return  $\arg \min(\sum_{j=1 \dots N} TM_j + \sum_{k=j+1}^N TC_k + TU_j)$ 
17:   else if  $OptTarget == energy$  then
18:     return  $\arg \min(\sum_{j=1 \dots N} TM_j \times PM_j + TU_j \times PU)$ 

```

5.3 Partitioned Execution

We prototype Neurosurgeon by creating modified instances of Caffe [18] to serve as our mobile-side (NSmobile) and server-side (NSserver) infrastructures. Through these two variations of Caffe, we implement our client-server interface using Thrift [33], an open source flexible RPC interface for inter-process communication. To allow for flexibility in the dynamic selection of partition points, both NSmobile and NSserver host complete DNN models, and partition points are enforced by NSmobile and NSserver runtime. Given a partition decision by NSmobile, execution begins on the mobile device and cascades through the layers of the DNN leading up to that partition point. Upon completion of that layer, NSmobile sends the output of that layer from the mobile device to NSserver residing on the server side. NSserver then executes the remaining DNN layers. Upon the completion of the DNN execution, the final result is sent back to NSmobile on the mobile device from NSserver. Note that there is exactly one partition point within the DNN for which information is sent from the mobile device to the cloud.

6. Evaluation

We evaluate Neurosurgeon using 8 DNNs (Table 3) as our benchmarks across Wi-Fi, LTE and 3G wireless connections with both CPU-only and GPU mobile platforms. We demonstrate Neurosurgeon achieves significant end-to-end latency and mobile energy improvements over the status quo cloud-only approach (Sections 6.1 and 6.2). We then compare Neurosurgeon against MAUI [34], a well-known

表 4: Neurosurgeon 的分区点选择以获得最佳端到端延迟。绿色块表示 Neurosurgeon 做出了最佳划分选择, 白色块表示选择了次优划分点。平均而言, Neurosurgeon 达到最佳性能的 98.5% 以内。

Mobile	Wireless network	Benchmarks							
		IMC	VGG	FACE	DIG	ASR	POS	NER	CHK
CPU	Wi-Fi	input	input	input	input	input	fc3		
	LTE	input	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	3G	argmax	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
GPU	Wi-Fi	pool5	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	LTE	argmax	argmax	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	3G	argmax	argmax	argmax	argmax	input	fc3		

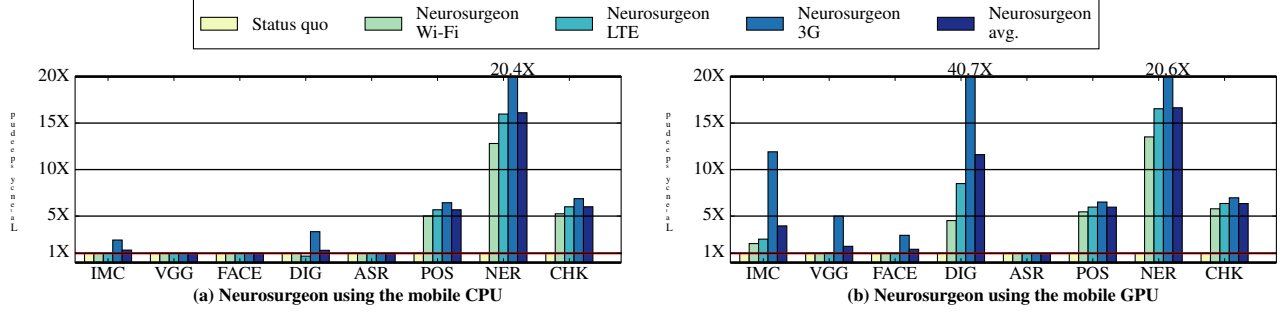


图 11: 通过归一化至现状方法 (在云中执行整个 DNN) 的 Neurosurgeon 实现延迟加速。此处显示了三种无线网络 (Wi-Fi、LTE 和 3G) 以及移动 CPU 和 GPU 的结果。Neurosurgeon 将端到端 DNN 推理延迟平均提高了 $3.1\times$ (几何平均值), 最高可达 $40.7\times$ 。

移动 (TM_i) 和云 (TC_i), 同时考虑当前数据中心负载水平 (K)。第 13 行估计移动设备上执行层 L_i 的功率 (PM_i), 第 14 行根据最新的无线网络带宽计算无线数据传输延迟 (TU_i)。

分区点选择 - Neurosurgeon 然后选择最佳分区点。候选点位于每一层之后。第 16 行和第 18 行评估在每个候选点进行分区时的性能, 并选择最佳端到端延迟或最佳移动能耗的点。由于回归模型的简单性, 这种评估是轻量级且高效的。

Algorithm 1 Neurosurgeon DNN partitioning algorithm

```

1: Input:
2:  $N$ : number of layers in the DNN
3:  $\{L_i | i = 1 \dots N\}$ : layers in the DNN
4:  $\{D_i | i = 1 \dots N\}$ : data size at each layer
5:  $f, g(L_i)$ : regression models predicting the latency and power of executing  $L_i$ 
6:  $K$ : current datacenter load level
7:  $B$ : current wireless network uplink bandwidth
8:  $PU$ : wireless network uplink power consumption
9: procedure PARTITIONDECISION
10:   for each  $i$  in  $1 \dots N$  do
11:      $TM_i \leftarrow f_{mobile}(L_i)$ 
12:      $TC_i \leftarrow f_{cloud}(L_i, K)$ 
13:      $PM_i \leftarrow g_{mobile}(L_i)$ 
14:      $TU_i \leftarrow D_i/B$ 
15:   if  $OptTarget == latency$  then
16:     return  $\arg \min (\sum_{j=1 \dots N} TM_j + \sum_{k=j+1}^N TC_k + TU_j)$ 
17:   else if  $OptTarget == energy$  then
18:     return  $\arg \min (\sum_{j=1 \dots N} TM_j \times PM_j + TU_j \times PU)$ 

```

5.3 分区执行

我们通过创建 Caffe [18] 的修改实例来原型化 Neurosurgeon, 以用作我们的移动端 (NSmobile) 和服务端 (NSserver) 基础设施。通过 Caffe 的这两个变体, 我们使用 Thrift [33] 实现客户端-服务器接口, Thrift 是一个用于进程间通信的开源灵活 RPC 接口。为了实现动态选择分区点的灵活性, NSmo-、bile和NSserver 都托管完整的DNN模型, 并且分区点由NSmobile和NSserver运行时强制执行。给定 NSmobile 的分区决策, 执行开始在移动设备上, 并级联通过 DNN 的各层, 直至该分区点。该层完成后, NSmobile 将该层的输出从移动设备发送到驻留在服务器端的 NSserver。NSserver 然后执行剩余的 DNN 层。DNN 执行完成后, 最终结果从 NSserver 发送回移动设备上的 NSmobile。请注意, DNN 中只有一个分区点, 信息从移动设备发送到云端。

六、评价

我们使用 8 个 DNN (表 3) 作为 Wi-Fi、LTE 和 3G 无线连接与仅 CPU 和 GPU 移动平台的基准来评估 Neurosurgeon。我们证明, 与现状的纯云方法 (第 6.1 和 6.2 节) 相比, Neurosurgeon 实现了显着的端到端延迟和移动能源改进。然后我们将 Neurosurgeon 与 MAUI [34] 进行比较, MAUI [34] 是一个众所周知的

Table 5: Neurosurgeon partition point selections for best mobile energy consumption. Green block indicates Neurosurgeon makes the optimal partition choice and white block means a suboptimal partition point is picked. On average, Neurosurgeon achieves a mobile energy reduction within 98.8% of the optimal reduction.

Mobile	Wireless network	Benchmarks							
		IMC	VGG	FACE	DIG	ASR	POS	NER	CHK
CPU	Wi-Fi	input	input	input	input	input	fc3		
	LTE	input	input	input	input	input	fc3		
	3G	input	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
GPU	Wi-Fi	input	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	LTE	pool5	input	input	argmax	input	fc3		
	3G	argmax	argmax	input	argmax	input	fc3		

□ Status quo	■ Neurosurgeon Wi-Fi	■ Neurosurgeon LTE	■ Neurosurgeon 3G	■ Neurosurgeon avg.
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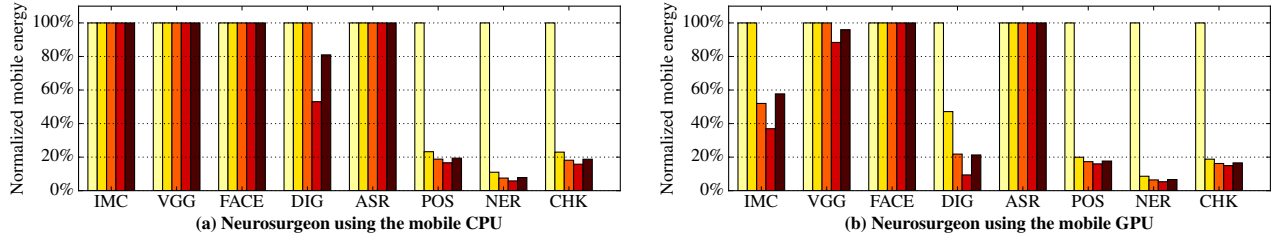


Figure 12: Mobile energy consumption achieved by Neurosurgeon normalized to status quo approach (executing entire DNN in the cloud). Results for three wireless networks (Wi-Fi, LTE and 3G) and mobile CPU and GPU are shown here. Neurosurgeon reduces the mobile energy consumption by 59.5% on average (geometric mean) and up to 94.7%.

computation offloading framework (Section 6.3). We also evaluate Neurosurgeon’s robustness to variations in wireless network connections (Section 6.4) and server load (Section 6.5), demonstrating the need for such a dynamic runtime system. Finally, we evaluate the datacenter throughput improvement Neurosurgeon achieves by pushing compute out of the cloud to the mobile device (Section 6.6).

6.1 Latency Improvement

Partition Point Selection – Table 4 summarizes the partition points selected by Neurosurgeon optimizing for latency across the 48 configurations (i.e., 8 benchmarks, 3 wireless network types, mobile CPU and GPU). The green cells indicate when Neurosurgeon selects the optimal partition point and achieves the best speedup while the white cells indicate Neurosurgeon selects a suboptimal point. Neurosurgeon selects the best partition point for 44 out of the 48 configurations. The mispredictions occur because the partition points and its associated performance are very close to one another and thus a small difference in Neurosurgeon’s latency prediction shifts the selection. Across all benchmarks and configurations, Neurosurgeon achieves latency speedup within 98.5% of optimal speedup.

Latency Improvement – Figure 11 shows Neurosurgeon’s latency improvement over the status quo approach, across the 8 benchmarks on Wi-Fi, LTE, and 3G. Figure 11a shows the latency improvement when applying Neurosurgeon to a mobile platform equipped with a CPU, and Figure 11b shows that of a mobile platform with a GPU. For CV applications, Neurosurgeon identifies the best partition points for 20 out of 24 cases and achieves significant latency

speedups, especially when the mobile GPU is available. For the NLP applications, Neurosurgeon achieves significant latency speedups even when Wi-Fi is available. For ASR, Neurosurgeon successfully identifies that it is best to execute the DNN entirely on the server and, therefore Neurosurgeon performs similar to the status quo for that particular benchmark. Across all benchmarks and configurations, Neurosurgeon achieves a latency speedup of $3.1\times$ on average and up to $40.7\times$ over the status quo approach.

6.2 Energy Improvement

Partition Point Selection – Table 5 summarizes the partition points identified by Neurosurgeon for best mobile energy. Neurosurgeon selects the best partition point for 44 out of the 48 configurations. For the suboptimal choices, Neurosurgeon consumes 24.2% less energy on average than the status quo approach.

Energy Improvement – Figure 12 shows the mobile energy consumption achieved by Neurosurgeon, normalized to the status quo approach. Figure 12a and 12b present results for CPU-only mobile platform and GPU-equipped mobile platform, respectively. When optimizing for best energy consumption, Neurosurgeon achieves on average a 59.5% reduction in mobile energy and up to 94.7% reduction over the status quo. Similar to the improvement for latency, the energy reduction is also higher for most benchmarks when the mobile platform is equipped with a GPU.

6.3 Comparing Neurosurgeon to MAUI

In this section, we compare Neurosurgeon to MAUI [34], a general offloading framework. Note that MAUI is control-

表 5: 最佳移动能耗的 Neurosurgeon 划分点选择。绿色块表示 Neurosurgeon 做出了最佳划分选择, 白色块表示选择了次优划分点。平均而言, Neurosurgeon 实现的移动能源减少量在最佳减少量的 98.8% 以内。

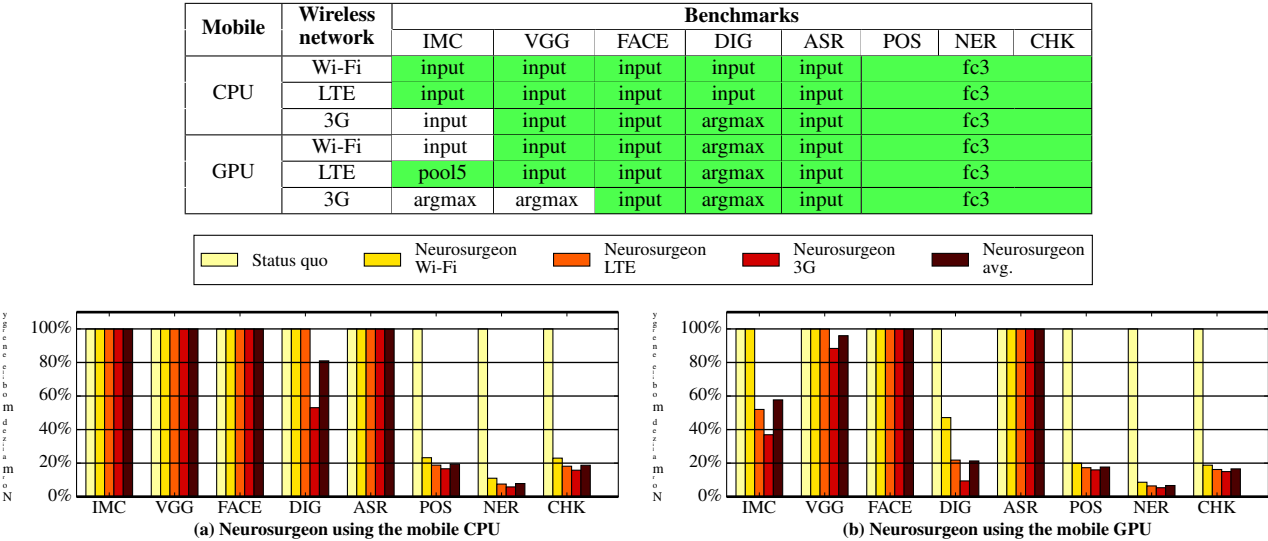


图 12: 通过 Neurosurgeon 归一化至现状方法 (在云中执行整个 DNN) 实现的移动能耗。此处显示了三种无线网络 (Wi-Fi、LTE 和 3G) 以及移动 CPU 和 GPU 的结果。Neurosurgeon 移动能耗平均降低 59.5% (几何平均值), 最高可达 94.7%。

计算泛洪框架 (第 6.3 节)。我们还评估了 Neurosurgeon 对无线网络连接 (第 6.4 节) 和服务负载 (第 6.5 节) 变化的鲁棒性, 证明了对这种动态运行时系统的需求。最后, 我们评估通过将计算从云端推送到移动设备来实现的数据中心吞吐量改进 Neurosurgeon (第 6.6 节)。

6.1 延迟改善

分区点选择 - 表 4 总结了 Neurosurgeon 在 48 种配置 (即 8 个基准、3 种无线网络类型、移动 CPU 和 GPU) 中优化延迟时选择的分区点。绿色单元格表示 Neurosurgeon 选择最佳分割点并实现最佳加速, 而白色单元格表示 Neurosurgeon 选择次优点。Neurosurgeon 为 48 个配置中的 44 个选择最佳划分点。发生错误预测是因为分区点及其相关性能彼此非常接近, 因此 Neurosurgeon 的延迟预测中的微小差异会改变选择。在所有基准测试和配置中, Neurosurgeon 在最佳加速的 98.5% 内实现了延迟加速。

延迟改进 - 图 11 显示了在 Wi-Fi、LTE 和 3G 的 8 个基准测试中, Neurosurgeon 相对于现状方法的延迟改进。图 11a 显示了将 Neurosurgeon 应用于配备 CPU 的移动平台时的延迟改进, 图 11b 显示了配备 GPU 的移动平台的延迟改进。对于 CV 应用, Neurosurgeon 识别 24 个案例中的 20 个的最佳划分点, 并实现显著的延迟

加速, 特别是当移动 GPU 可用时。对于 NLP 应用程序, 即使 Wi-Fi 可用, Neurosurgeon 也能实现显著的延迟加速。对于 ASR, Neurosurgeon 成功地确定最好完全在服务器上执行 DNN, 因此 Neurosurgeon 的性能与该特定基准的现状类似。在所有基准测试和配置中, Neurosurgeon 的延迟加速平均为 3.1 $\times$, 与现状方法相比最高可达 40.7 $\times$ 。

6.2 能源改进

分配点选择——表 5 总结了由 Neurosurgeon 确定的最佳移动能量的分配点。Neurosurgeon 为 48 个配置中的 44 个选择最佳划分点。对于次优选择, Neurosurgeon 比现状方法平均消耗 24.2% 的能量。

能源改进——图 12 显示了 Neurosurgeon 实现的移动能源消耗, 标准化为现状方法。图 12a 和 12b 分别显示了仅使用 CPU 的移动平台和配备 GPU 的移动平台的结果。在优化最佳能源消耗时, Neurosurgeon 的移动能源平均减少 59.5%, 比现状减少高达 94.7%。与延迟的改进类似, 当移动平台配备 GPU 时, 大多数基准测试的能耗降低也更高。

6.3 神经外科医生与 MAUI 的比较

在本节中, 我们将 Neurosurgeon 与通用卸载框架 MAUI [34] 进行比较。请注意, MAUI 是控制-

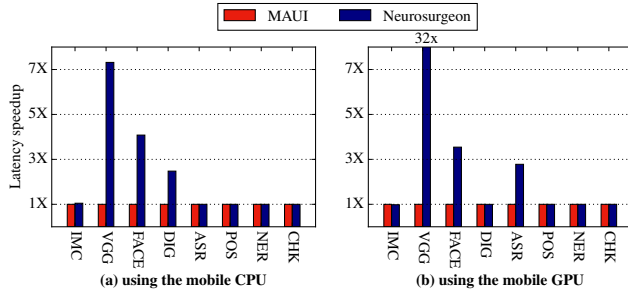


Figure 13: Latency speedup achieved by Neurosurgeon vs. MAUI [34]. For MAUI, we assume the optimal programmer annotation that achieves minimal program state transfer. Neurosurgeon outperforms MAUI by up to 32 $\times$ and 1.9 $\times$ on average.

centric, reasoning and making decisions about regions of code (functions), whereas Neurosurgeon is data-centric, making partition decisions based on the structure of the data topology that can differ even if the same code region (function) is called.

Figure 13 presents the latency speedup achieved by Neurosurgeon normalized to MAUI when executing the 8 DNN benchmarks, averaged across three wireless network types. Figure 13a presents the result when applying MAUI and Neurosurgeon on a CPU-only mobile platform and Figure 13b presents the result on a mobile platform equipped with a GPU. In this experiment, we assume that for MAUI, programmers have optimally annotated the minimal program states that need to be transferred.

Figure 13 shows that Neurosurgeon significantly outperforms MAUI on the computer vision applications. For the NLP applications, both Neurosurgeon and MAUI correctly decide that local computation on the mobile device is optimal. However, MAUI makes incorrect offloading choices for more complicated scenarios (e.g., VGG, FACE, DIG and ASR). This is because MAUI relies on past invocation of a certain DNN layer type to predict the latency and data size of the future invocations of that layer type, leading to mispredictions. This control-centric prediction mechanism is not suitable for DNN layers because the latency and data size of layers of the same type can be drastically different within one DNN, and Neurosurgeon’s DNN analysis step and prediction model correctly captures this variation. For instance, in VGG, the input data size for the first and second convolution layers are significantly different: 0.57MB for conv1.1, and 12.25MB for conv1.2. For the mobile CPU and LTE, MAUI decides to offload the DNN before conv1.2 due to its misprediction, uploading large amount of data and resulting in a 20.5 $\times$ slowdown over the status quo approach. Meanwhile, Neurosurgeon successfully identifies that for this case it is best to execute the DNN entirely in the cloud, and thus achieves similar performance as the status quo and a 20.5 $\times$ speedup over MAUI.

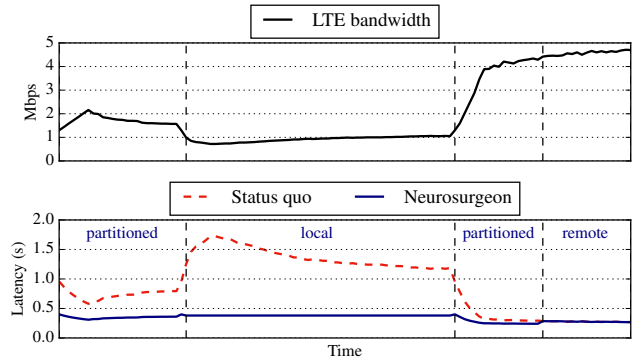


Figure 14: The top graph shows bandwidth variance using a LTE network. The bottom graph shows the latency of AlexNet (IMC) of the status quo and Neurosurgeon. Neurosurgeon’s decisions are annotated on the bottom graph. Neurosurgeon provides consistent latency by adjusting its partitioned execution based on the available bandwidth.

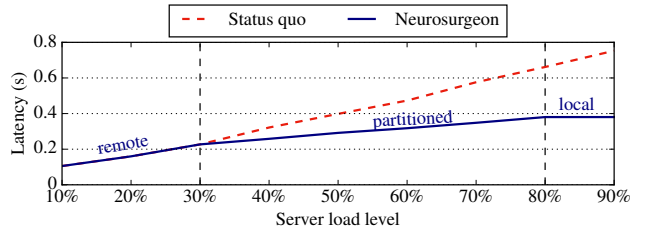


Figure 15: Neurosurgeon adjusts its partitioned execution as the result of varying datacenter load.

6.4 Network Variation

In this section, we evaluate Neurosurgeon’s resilience to real-world measured wireless network variations. In Figure 14, the top graph shows measured wireless bandwidth of T-Mobile LTE network over a period of time. The bottom graph shows the end-to-end latency of the status quo approach and Neurosurgeon executing AlexNet (IMC) on the mobile CPU platform. Annotated on the bottom graph is Neurosurgeon’s dynamic execution choice, categorized as either local, remote or partitioned. The status quo approach is highly susceptible to network variations and consequently the application suffers significant latency increases during the low bandwidth phase. Conversely, Neurosurgeon successfully mitigates the effects of large variations and provides consistent low latency by shifting partition choice to adjust the amount of data transfer based on the available bandwidth.

6.5 Server Load Variation

In this section, we evaluate how Neurosurgeon makes dynamic decision as the server load varies. Datacenters typically experience diurnal load patterns and high server utilization leads to increased service time for DNN queries. Neurosurgeon determines the best partition point based on the current server load level obtained by periodically pinging

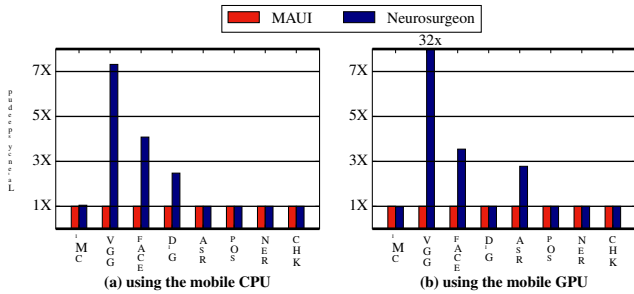


图 13: Neurosurgeon 与 MAUI [34] 实现的延迟加速。对于 MAUI, 我们假设实现小程序状态传输的最佳程序员注释。Neurosurgeon 的平均性能比 MAUI 高出 32 $\times$ 和 1.9 $\times$ 。

以数据为中心, 对代码区域(函数)进行推理和决策, 而 Neurosurgeon 以数据为中心, 根据数据拓扑结构做出分区决策, 即使调用相同的代码区域(函数), 数据拓扑结构也可能有所不同。

图 13 显示了执行 8 个 DNN 基准测试时, 通过归一化为 MAUI 的 Neurosurgeon 实现的延迟加速, 这是三种无线网络类型的平均值。图 13a 显示了在仅使用 CPU 的移动平台上应用 MAUI 和 Neurosurgeon 时的结果, 图 13b 显示了在配备 GPU 的移动平台上的结果。在这个实验中, 我们假设对于 MAUI, 程序员已经最佳地注释了需要传输的最小程序状态。

图 13 显示 Neurosurgeon 在计算机视觉应用上的表现明显优于 MAUI。对于 NLP 应用程序, Neurosurgeon 和 MAUI 都正确地确定移动设备上的本地计算是最佳的。然而, MAUI 对于更复杂的场景(例如 VGG、FACE、DIG 和 ASR)会做出错误的卸载选择。这是因为 MAUI 依赖于过去对某个 DNN 层类型的调用来预测该层类型未来调用的延迟和数据大小, 从而导致错误预测。这种以控制为中心的预测机制并不适合 DNN 层, 因为同一类型的层的延迟和数据大小在一个 DNN 内可能截然不同, 而 Neurosurgeon 的 DNN 分析步骤和预测模型正确地捕获了这种变化。例如, 在 VGG 中, 第一和第二卷积层的输入数据大小显著不同: conv1.1 为 0.57MB, conv1.2 为 12.25MB。对于移动 CPU 和 LTE, MAUI 决定在 conv1.2 之前卸载 DNN, 因为它的预测错误, 上传大量数据并导致比现状方法慢 20.5 $\times$ 。同时, Neurosurgeon 成功地确定, 对于这种情况, 最好完全在云端执行 DNN, 从而实现与现状类似的性能, 并且比 MAUI 加速 20.5 $\times$ 。

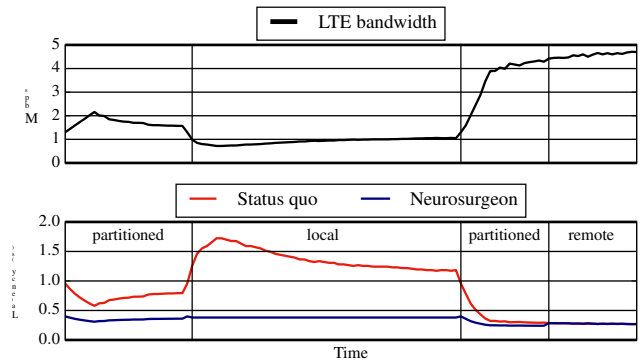


图 14: 上图显示了使用 LTE 网络的带宽变化。下图显示了 AlexNet (IMC) 现状和 Neurosurgeon 的延迟。Neurosurgeon 的决策在底部图表上进行了注释。Neurosurgeon 通过根据可用带宽调整其分区执行来提供一致的延迟。

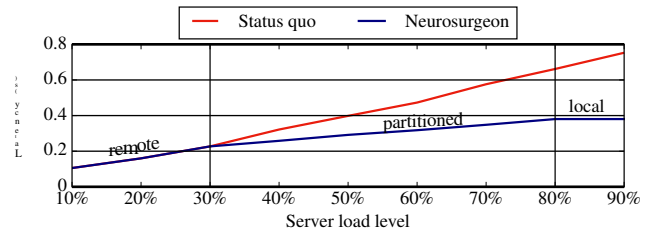


图 15: Neurosurgeon 根据数据中心负载变化调整其分区执行。

6.4 网络变化

在本节中, 我们评估 Neurosurgeon 对现实世界测量的无线网络变化的恢复能力。在图 14 中, 顶部图表显示了一段时间内测量的 T-Mobile LTE 网络无线带宽。下图显示了现状方法和在移动 CPU 平台上执行 AlexNet (IMC) 的 Neurosurgeon 的端到端延迟。底部图表中注释的是 Neurosurgeon 的动态执行选择, 分为本地、远程或分区。现状方法非常容易受到网络变化的影响, 因此应用程序在低带宽阶段会遭受显著的延迟增加。相反, Neurosurgeon 成功地减轻了大变化的影响, 并通过改变分区选择以根据可用带宽调整数据传输量来提供一致的低延迟。

6.5 服务器负载变化

在本节中, 我们评估 Neurosurgeon 如何在服务器负载变化时做出动态决策。数据中心通常会经历昼夜负载模式, 而高服务器利用率会导致 DNN 查询的服务时间增加。Neurosurgeon 根据定期 ping 得到的当前服务器负载水平确定最佳分区点

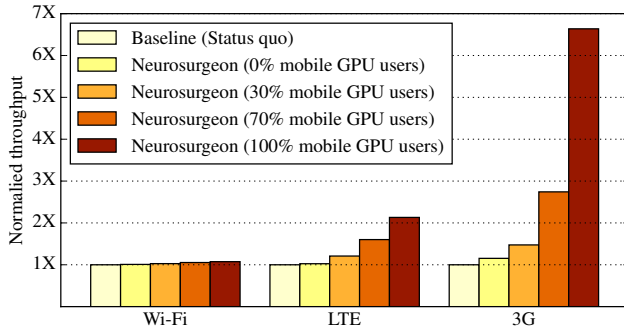


Figure 16: Datacenter throughput improvement achieved by Neurosurgeon over the status quo approach. Higher throughput improvement is achieved by Neurosurgeon for cellular networks (LTE and 3G) and as more mobile devices are equipped with GPUs.

the server during idle period, and thus avoids long latency caused by high user demand and the resulting high load.

Figure 15 presents the end-to-end latency of AlexNet (IMC) achieved by the status quo approach and Neurosurgeon as the server load increases. The mobile device is equipped with a CPU and transfers data via Wi-Fi. As shown in the figure, the status quo approach does not dynamically adapt to varying server load and thus suffers from significant performance degradation when the server load is high. The end-to-end latency of the status quo approach increases from 105ms to 753ms as the server approaches its peak load level. On the other hand, by taking server load into consideration, Neurosurgeon dynamically adapts the partition point. In Figure 15, two vertical dashed lines represent the points where Neurosurgeon changes its selection: from complete cloud execution at low load, to partitioning the DNN between mobile and cloud at medium load, and eventually completely onloading to mobile at peak load. Regardless of the server load, Neurosurgeon keeps the end-to-end latency of executing image classification below 380ms. By considering server load and its impact on the server performance, Neurosurgeon consistently delivers the best latency regardless of the variation in server load.

6.6 Datacenter Throughput Improvement

Neurosurgeon onloads part or all of the computation from the cloud to mobile devices to improve end-to-end latency and reduce mobile energy consumption. This new compute paradigm reduces the computation required on the datacenter, leading to shorter query service time and higher query throughput. In this section, we evaluate Neurosurgeon’s effectiveness in this aspect. We use BigHouse [38] to compare the achieved datacenter throughput between status quo and Neurosurgeon. The incoming DNN queries are composed evenly of the 8 DNNs in the benchmark suite. We use the measured mean service time of DNN queries combined with Google web search query distribution for the query inter-arrival rate.

Figure 16 presents the datacenter throughput improvement achieved by Neurosurgeon, normalized to the baseline status quo approach of executing the entire computation on the server. Each cluster presents results for a given wireless network type. Within each cluster, the first bar represents the status quo cloud-only approach, while the other four bars represent Neurosurgeon with different compositions of the mobile hardware. For example, “30% Mobile GPU users” indicates 30% of the incoming requests are from mobile devices equipped with a GPU while the remaining 70% are from devices equipped only with a CPU.

When the mobile clients are connected to the server via fast Wi-Fi network, Neurosurgeon achieves on average $1.04\times$ throughput improvement. As the wireless connection changes to LTE and 3G, the throughput improvement becomes more significant: $1.43\times$ for LTE and $2.36\times$ for 3G. Neurosurgeon adapts its partition choice and pushes larger portions of the DNN computation to the mobile devices as the wireless connection quality becomes less ideal. Therefore the average request query service time is reduced and a higher throughput is achieved in the datacenter. We also observe that as the percentage of mobile devices with GPU increases, Neurosurgeon increases the computation onloading from the cloud to mobile, leading to higher datacenter throughput improvement.

7. Related Work

Previous research efforts focus on offloading computation from the mobile to cloud. In Table 6, we compare Neurosurgeon with the most relevant techniques on properties including whether there is heavy data transfer overhead, data-centric or control-centric partitioning, low run-time overhead, whether application-specific profiling is required, and whether programmer’s annotation is needed.

In addition to these key differences, computation partition frameworks have to make predictions as to when to offload computation and the correctness of the prediction dictates the final performance improvements for the application. COMET [35] offloads a thread when its execution time exceeds a pre-defined threshold, ignoring any other information (amount of data to transfer, wireless network available, etc.). Odessa [36] makes computation partition decisions only considering the execution time and data requirements of part of the function, without taking the entire application into consideration. CloneCloud [37] makes the same offloading decisions for all invocations of the same function. MAUI’s [34] offloading decision mechanism is better in that it makes predictions for each function invocation separately and considers the entire application when choosing which function to offload. However, MAUI is not applicable for the computation partition performed by Neurosurgeon for a number of reasons: 1) MAUI requires a profiling step for each individual application, whereas predictions are required to perform DNN partitioning. Neurosurgeon makes deci-

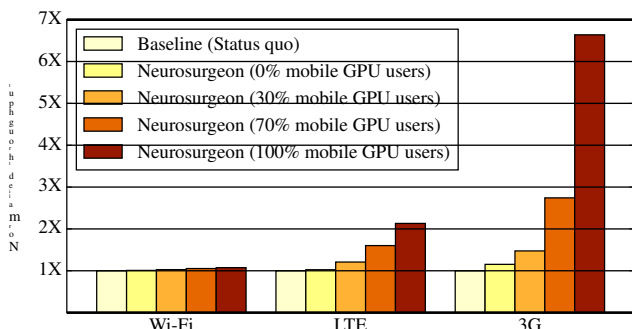


图 16: Neuro- surgeon 相对于现状方法实现的数据中心吞吐量改进。随着越来越多的移动设备配备 GPU，蜂窝网络（LTE 和 3G）的 Neurosurgeon 可以实现更高的吞吐量改进。

服务器在空闲期间，从而避免因用户需求高而导致的长时间延迟和由此产生的高负载。

图 15 显示了随着服务器负载增加，通过现状方法和 Neuro- surgeon 实现的 AlexNet (IMC) 的端到端延迟。移动设备配备 CPU 并通过 Wi-Fi 传输数据。如图所示，现状方法不能动态适应不断变化的服务器负载，因此当服务器负载较高时，性能会显著下降。随着服务器接近其峰值负载水平，现状方法的端到端延迟从 105 毫秒增加到 753 毫秒。另一方面，通过考虑服务器负载，Neurosurgeon 动态调整分区点。在图 15 中，两条垂直虚线代表 Neurosurgeon 更改其选择的点：从低负载时的完全云执行，到中等负载时在移动设备和云之间划分 DNN，以及最终在峰值负载时完全加载到移动设备。无论服务器负载如何，Neurosurgeon 都能将执行图像分类的端到端延迟保持在 380 毫秒以下。通过考虑服务器负载及其对服务器性能的影响，无论服务器负载如何变化，Neurosurgeon 都能始终提供最佳延迟。

6.6 数据中心吞吐量提升

Neurosurgeon 将部分或全部计算从云端加载到移动设备，以改善端到端延迟并降低移动能耗。这种新的计算范式减少了数据中心所需的计算，从而缩短了查询服务时间并提高了查询吞吐量。在本节中，我们评估 Neurosurgeon 在这方面的有效性。我们使用 BigHouse [38] 来比较现状和 Neurosurgeon 之间实现的数据中心吞吐量。传入的 DNN 查询均匀地由基准套件中的 8 个 DNN 组成。我们使用测得的 DNN 查询平均服务时间与 Google 网络搜索查询分布相结合来计算查询间隔到达率。

图 16 显示了 Neurosurgeon 实现的数据中心吞吐量改进，标准化为在服务器上执行整个计算的基线现状方法。每个集群呈现给定无线网络类型的结果。在每个集群中，第一个条代表现状的纯云方法，而其他四个条代表具有不同移动硬件组成的 Neurosurgeon。例如，“30% 移动 GPU 用户”表示 30% 的传入请求来自配备 GPU 的移动设备，而其余 70% 来自仅配备 CPU 的设备。

当移动客户端通过快速 Wi-Fi 网络连接到服务器时，Neurosurgeon 的吞吐量平均提高了 1.04x。随着无线连接变为 LTE 和 3G，吞吐量改进变得更加显著：LTE 为 1.43x，3G 为 2.36x。当无线连接质量变得不太理想时，Neurosurgeon 会调整其分区选择，并将 DNN 计算的较大部分推送到移动设备。因此，减少了平均请求查询服务时间，并在数据中心实现了更高的吞吐量。我们还观察到，随着配备 GPU 的移动设备比例的增加，Neurosurgeon 增加了从云到移动设备的计算负载，从而提高了数据中心吞吐量。

七、相关工作

之前的研究工作主要集中在将计算从移动设备转移到云端。在表 6 中，我们将 Neuro- surgeon 与最相关的属性技术进行了比较，包括是否存在大量数据传输开销、以数据为中心或以控制为中心的分区、低运行时开销、是否需要特定于应用程序的分析以及是否需要程序员的注释。

除了这些关键差异之外，计算分区框架还必须预测何时卸载计算，并且预测的正确性决定了应用程序的最终性能改进。当执行时间超过预先定义的阈值时，COMET [35] 会卸载线程，忽略任何其他信息（要传输的数据量、可用的无线网络等）。Odessa [36] 仅考虑部分函数的执行时间和数据要求来做出计算分区决策，而不考虑整个应用程序。CloneCloud [37] 对同一函数的所有调用做出相同的卸载决策。MAUI 的 [34] 卸载决策机制更好，因为它单独对每个函数调用进行预测，并在选择卸载哪个函数时考虑整个应用程序。然而，MAUI 不适用于 Neurosurgeon 执行的计算分区，原因如下：1) MAUI 需要对每个单独的应用程序进行分析步骤，而执行 DNN 分区则需要预测。Neurosurgeon 做出决定-

Table 6: Comparing Neurosurgeon to popular computation offloading/partition frameworks

	MAUI [34]	Comet [35]	Odessa [36]	CloneCloud [37]	Neurosurgeon
No need to transfer program state			✓		✓
Data-centric compute partitioning			✓		✓
Low/no runtime overhead	✓		✓	✓	✓
Requires no application-specific profiling		✓			✓
No programmer annotation needed		✓	✓	✓	✓
Server load sensitive			✓		✓

sions based on the DNN topology without any runtime profiling. 2) MAUI is control-centric, making decisions about regions of code (functions), whereas Neurosurgeon makes partition decisions based on the structure of the data topology that can differ even if the same code region (function) is executed. Layers of a given type (even if mapped to the same function) within one DNN can have significantly different compute and data characteristics. 3) Neurosurgeon transfers only the data that is being processed in contrast to transferring all program state. 4) MAUI requires the programmer to annotate their programs to identify which methods are “offload-able”.

In addition to prior work investigating the utilization and efficiency of datacenter systems [39–52], there has been growing interest in building large scale datacenter systems for Deep Neural Network workloads. Various accelerators, such as GPUs, ASICs, and FPGAs, have been proposed for datacenters to better handle DNN computation [9, 53–55]. There has also been effort in designing compact DNNs suitable for the mobile edge. Microsoft and Google explore small-scale DNNs for speech recognition on mobile platforms [56, 57]. MCDNN [58] proposes generating alternative DNN models to trade-off accuracy for performance/energy and choosing to execute either in the cloud or on the mobile. This work investigates intelligent collaboration between the mobile device and cloud for executing traditionally cloud-only large-scale DNNs for reduced latency and energy consumption without sacrificing the DNNs’ high prediction accuracy.

8. Conclusion

As an essential component of today’s intelligent applications, Deep Neural Networks have been traditionally executed in the cloud. In this work, we examine the efficacy of this status quo approach of cloud-only processing and show that it is not always optimal to transfer the input data to the server and remotely execute the DNN. We investigate the compute and data characteristics of 8 DNN architectures spanning computer vision, speech, and natural language processing applications and show the trade-off of partitioning computation at different points within the neural network. With these insights, we develop Neurosurgeon, a system that can automatically partition DNN between the mobile device and cloud at the granularity of neural network layers. Neurosurgeon adapts to various DNN architectures, hardware platforms, wireless connections, and server load levels, and chooses the partition point for best la-

tency and best mobile energy consumption. Across 8 benchmarks, when compared to cloud-only processing, Neurosurgeon achieves on average $3.1\times$ and up to $40.7\times$ latency speedup, reduces mobile energy consumption by on average 59.5% and up to 94.7%, and improves datacenter throughput by on average $1.5\times$ and up to $6.7\times$.

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表 6: 将 Neurosurgeon 与流行的加载/分区计算框架进行比较

	MAUI [34]	Comet [35]	Odessa [36]	CloneCloud [37]	Neurosurgeon
No need to transfer program state			✓		✓
Data-centric compute partitioning			✓		✓
Low/no runtime overhead	✓		✓	✓	✓
Requires no application-specific profiling		✓			✓
No programmer annotation needed		✓	✓	✓	✓
Server load sensitive			✓		✓

基于 DNN 拓扑的系统，无需任何运行时分析。2) MAUI 以控制为中心，对代码（函数）区域做出决策，而 Neurosurgeon 根据数据拓扑结构做出分区决策，即使执行相同的代码区域（函数），数据拓扑结构也可能不同。一个 DNN 中给定类型的层（即使映射到相同的函数）可能具有显著不同的计算和数据特征。3) Neurosurgeon 仅传输正在处理的数据，而不是传输所有程序状态。4) MAUI 要求程序员对其程序进行注释，以识别哪些方法是“可卸载的”。

除了先前研究数据中心系统的利用率和效率的工作之外[39-52]，人们对为深度神经网络工作负载构建大规模数据中心系统越来越感兴趣。人们已经为数据中心提出了各种加速器，例如 GPU、ASIC 和 FPGA，以更好地处理 DNN 计算 [9, 53–55]。人们还致力于设计适合移动边缘的紧凑型 DNN。Microsoft 和 Google 探索用于移动平台上语音识别的小型 DNN [56, 57]。MCDNN [58]建议生成替代的 DNN 模型，以权衡性能/能源的准确性，并选择在云端或移动设备上执行。这项工作研究了移动设备和云之间的智能协作，用于执行传统上仅在云中的大规模 DNN，以减少延迟和能耗，同时又不牺牲 DNN 的高预测精度。

八、结论

作为当今智能应用程序的重要组成部分，深度神经网络传统上是在云端执行的。在这项工作中，我们研究了这种仅云处理的现状方法的有效性，并表明将输入数据传输到服务器并远程执行 DNN 并不总是最佳的。我们研究了涵盖计算机视觉、语音和自然语言处理应用的 8 个 DNN 架构的计算和数据特征，并展示了神经网络内不同点的分区计算的权衡。有了这些见解，我们开发了 Neurosurgeon，一个可以在神经网络层的粒度上自动在移动设备和云之间划分 DNN 的系统。Neurosurgeon 适应各种 DNN 架构、硬件平台、无线连接和服务器负载水平，并选择最佳的划分点

张力和最佳移动能耗。在 8 个基准测试中，与纯云处理相比，Neurosurgeon 实现了平均 $3.1\times$ 和高达 $40.7\times$ 的延迟加速，平均降低了 59.5% 和高达 94.7% 的移动能耗，并将数据中心吞吐量平均提高了 $1.5\times$ 和高达 $6.7\times$ 。

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